

BIG

**BIG TEN
BASKETBALL
PREVIEW**

2021-22

B1G Basketball Preview

This version of this B1G Preview was finalized on May 16th. A lot of things can and will change throughout the rest of the offseason that will make things in this guide inaccurate. Players will transfer in and out of the Big Ten, some players will remain in the draft while some will come back to school, and coaching staffs will continue to change. I listed all players by their year in school, not their eligibility! So if they were a sophomore last year, I labeled them as a junior this year, even though they still have 3 more seasons of eligibility. Most stats in this preview come from Sports Reference or KenPom. All recruiting rankings and numbers come from 247Sports and their Composite Rankings. Thank you for reading this, and hope it helps!

2021 B1G Recruiting Class Rankings

B1G		
Rank	School	National Rank
1	Michigan	1
2	Michigan State	9
3	Nebraska	16
4	Illinois	23
5	Wisconsin	31
6	Northwestern	34
7	Indiana	35
8	Purdue	37
9	Maryland	46
10	Ohio State	47
11	Iowa	66
12	Minnesota	89
13	Rutgers	96
14	Penn State	N/A

Highest Rated 2021 B1G Freshman

B1G		
Rank	Player	National Rank
1	 Caleb Houston	7
2	 Moussa Diabate	13
3	 Max Christie	16
4	 Bryce McGowens	25
5	 Tamar Bates	27
6	 Malaki Branham	34
7	 Trey Kaufman	40
8	 Kobe Bufkin	42
9	 Frankie Collins	43
10	 Jaden Akins	50
11	 Julian Reese	56
12	 Pierre Brooks	57
13	 Caleb Furst	61
14	 Logan Duncomb	69

2021-22 B1G Power Rankings

These rankings are my personal opinion.

Tier 1: Final Four Contenders

1. Michigan
2. Purdue
3. Ohio State

Tier 2: NCAA Tournament Teams

4. Maryland
5. Michigan State
6. Indiana

Tier 3: Bubble Teams

7. Northwestern
8. Nebraska
9. Illinois
10. Rutgers
11. Iowa
12. Wisconsin

Tier 4: Building for the Future

13. Penn State
14. Minnesota

Draft Decisions to Watch

May 30th – Deadline to declare for draft
 June 21st-27th – NBA Draft Combine
 July 7th – Withdrawal deadline to remain NCAA eligible

-  Kofi Cockburn
-  Joe Wieskamp
-  Aaron Wiggins
-  Eric Ayala
-  Duane Washington Jr.
-  E.J. Liddell
-  Trevion Williams

Potential Breakout Candidates

-  Omar Payne
-  Khristian Lander
-  James Graham III
-  Julius Marble
-  Zed Key
-  Meechie Johnson Jr.
-  Jalen Pickett
-  Clifford Omoruyi
-  Chucky Hepburn



Illinois Fighting Illini

Head Coach: Brad Underwood
(5th Season, 71-56)

State Farm Center
Champaign, Illinois



Key Returning Players

Andre Curbelo	6'1"	G	9.1 PPG	21.5 MPG
Trent Frazier	6'2"	G	10.2 PPG	33.7 MPG
Da'Monte Williams	6'3"	G	5.5 PPG	24.9 MPG

Key Players Lost

Ayo Dosunmo	6'5"	G	20.1 PPG	35.1 MPG
Kofi Cockburn*	7'0"	C	17.7 PPG	27.0 MPG
Adam Miller	6'3"	G	8.3 PPG	25.5 MPG

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 24-7 (16-4 B1G) for a 2nd place finish in the B1G (Best since 2008-09). First NCAAT appearance since 2012-13. Earned a 1 seed, lost to Loyola-Chicago in the Round of 32.
- Finished 4th in NET ranking, 4th in KenPom, 2nd in the final AP Poll, and 8th in the final Coaches Poll.
- 12-5 Record in Quadrant I games.
- Ayo Dosunmu won the Bob Cousy Award, USA Today National Player of the Year, was a consensus First Team All-American, a Wooden Award finalist, Naismith Trophy finalist, unanimous First-Team All-Big Ten selection, and was the Big Ten Tournament Most Outstanding Player. Was the only player in the NCAA in the last 11 seasons to average at least 20 points, 6 rebounds, and 5 assist.
- Kofi Cockburn was named a consensus Second Team All-American, First Team All-Big Ten, and Kareem Abdul-Jabbar Award finalist. He was the only player in the NCAA to average 15+ points and 9+ rebounds while shooting over 60% from the field.
- Andre Curbelo won Big Ten Sixth Man of the Year and was named to the Big Ten All-Freshman Team. He was 27th nationally in assist rate, good for best on the team.
- Scored 80.5 PPG, 17th most in the nation. Finished 8th in adj. offensive efficiency (3rd B1G).
- Played man defense 99% of possessions. Gave up 68.6 PPG, 127th fewest in the nation. Finished 7th in adj. defensive efficiency (2nd B1G).
- Pace of 70.5 rated 79th in the NCAA and 2nd in the Big Ten.
- Forced teams into turnovers on only 16.0% of possessions (316th in the NCAA), but only allowed a 46.5% eFG rate (29th in the nation).
- Shot 37.2% from 3 (30th), but only 30% of their FGA were from 3 (320th highest). Williams was the top ranked 3P shooter in the nation at 55% on the season.

Offseason Timeline

- March 21** – Lost to Loyola-Chicago 71-58 in the Round of 32.
- April 1** – G Adam Miller enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to LSU.
- April 3** – Former Florida F Omar Payne commits to transfer to Illinois.
- April 6** – G Ayo Dosunmu declares for the NBA Draft and signs an agent.
- April 8** – F Giorgi Bezhanishvili announces that he will enter the NBA Draft and pursue other professional playing options.
- April 9** – G Trent Frazier declares for the NBA Draft but will maintain his college eligibility.
- April 13** – 2021 3-star G Brandin Podziemski commits to Illinois.
- April 17** – G Trent Frazier announces that he will return to Illinois to use his extra year of eligibility. Former Utah G Alfonso Plummer commits to transfer to Illinois.
- April 18** – C Kofi Cockburn declares for the NBA Draft but will still remain eligible to possibly return to Illinois.
- April 20** – C Jermaine Hamlin enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Eastern Illinois.
- April 28** – G Da'Monte Williams announces that he will return to Illinois to use his extra year of eligibility.
- April 29** – Assistant Coach Orlando Antigua announces that he will be leaving Illinois to take a job at Kentucky.
- May 3** – Assistant Coach Ronald Coleman announces that he will be leaving Illinois to take a job at Kentucky.
- May 6** – Chester Frazier (formerly at Virginia Tech) is announced as an Assistant Coach.

Returning Players

Player Information					2020-21 Season Stats							Notes		
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%			
#1 Trent Frazier	G	Super Sr.	6-2	175	31/31	33.7	10.2	2.7	2.7	40.0%	36.2%		83.1%	Has started 107 games in his 4 years at Illinois, including all 31 last season. Was selected to All-Big Ten Defensive Team and named as honorable mention for the All-Big 10 Team. Has scored 11.4 PPG in his career. With Dosunmu and Cockburn gone, he will likley see an increased scoring role this season. Led the Illini in 3P made last season. Career 36% 3P shooter.
#3 Jacob Grandison	G/F	RS Sr.	6-6	205	16/30	15.3	4.6	3.4	1.3	52.6%	41.5%		95.7%	Last year was his first playing at Illinois after starting his career at Holy Cross for two seasons, then sitting a year due to transfer rules. He played in 30 games, but started 16 of the last 17. He brought a spark to the starting lineup by doing all the little things. Making hustle plays and hitting open shots (42% 3P%, 53% FG%) was how he earned his role last year, and it will be how he contributes this year as well.
#5 Andre Curbelo	G	So.	6-1	175	0/31	21.5	9.1	4.0	4.2	49.8%	16.1%		72.8%	Former 4-star recruit; 47th ranked player in the 2020 class. Made an immediate impact as a freshman. Creative offensive player who can get to the rim at will. Needs to develop a 3P shot (only 16% from 3 last season) to really take the next step as a player. Will be one of the main players looked at to replace some of the production from Dosunmu.
#12 Brandon Lieb	C	So.	7-0	210	0/5	2.4	0.8	1.2	0.2	14.3%	N/A		100.0%	Former 3-star recruit. Only played 12 total minutes his freshman year. Still needs more time to develop his skills and athleticism, but has the 7 foot size that can't be taught. Likely won't play an on court role this year.
#13 Benjamin Bosmans-Verdonk	F	RS So.	6-8	235	0/8	2.3	0.3	0.4	0.0	33.3%	N/A		N/A	Missed the final 19 games of his freshman season and the first 11 games of his RS sophomore season due to a foot injury. His foot injury continued to hinder him through the rest of the season to the point where he only played 18 total minutes all year. Wasn't a high level recruit coming out of high school. Has an athletic prospect, and the Illini are hopeful he can provide something to the team, but it wouldn't be wise to count on it.
#20 Da'Monte Williams	G	Super Sr.	6-3	215	17/31	24.9	5.5	5.3	1.7	51.5%	54.7%		68.1%	Has played in 126 games in his 4 years at Illinois. Last year was his best scoring year at 5.5 PPG. Struggled from 3P range his first 3 years, only shooting 28% in those years combined. However, last year he led the nation in 3P% for player who shot more than two 3 pointers per game (55%!!!). Besides shooting, Williams is known for making hustle plays when needed.
#22 Austin Hutcherson	G	RS Sr.	6-6	180										Spent two years at Wesleyan where he started 51 games and averaged 20 PPG his sophomore year. Transferred to Illinois and had to sit a year due to transfer rules, then missed all last season due to a back injury. Is a versatile player. His best skill is his 3P shot. Illinois will be expecting him to play an on court role this season, but it's really hard to tell how much he's going to be able to provide in the Big Ten coming off of two years of no game minutes.
#33 Coleman Hawkins	F	So.	6-10	215	0/25	6.3	1.4	0.8	0.4	34.5%	23.1%		86.4%	Former 3-star recruit. Played in 10 or more minutes in 6 games last season. Described as a true stretch 4 who has the skills to do a little bit of everything. Will be a player that Illinois hopes can step up and replace a some of the production leaving the program this offseason.
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)					102.2 (50%)	30.8 (38%)	16.4 (41%)	10.2 (62%)						

New Players

	Position	Year	Height	Weight	Last School	Notes
Luke Goode	F	Fr.	6-7	200	Homestead (IN)	4-star recruit; 97th ranked player in the 2021 class. Smooth spot up shooter with good range. Very intelligent and effective player offensively off the ball. He can struggle to finish at the rim. Is a tweener defensively and will need to develop on that end of the floor. Project to be a role player that will make more of an impact as his career progresses.
RJ Melendez	F	Fr.	6-7	190	Central Pointe Christian (FL)	4-star recruit; 90th ranked player in the 2021 class. Long player who can jump and run well in transition. Good shooting skills, specifically in catch and shoot situations. Needs to gain strength to be able to compete defensively and on the boards in the Big Ten.
Brandin Podziemski	G	Fr.	6-5	195	St. John's Northwestern Academies (WI)	4-star recruit; 103rd ranked player in the 2021 class. Had lots of hype as one of the most underrated players in this class before jumping over 50 spots in the 2021 rankings this May. Wisconsin Mr. Basketball in 2021. Combo guard who ran the point during his senior year of high school. Legitimate 3 level scorer. Well rounded player who does lots of things well.
Omar Payne	F	Jr.	6-10	230	Florida	Former 4-star recruit; 45th ranked player in the 2019 class. Potential NBA player due to size and athleticism. Known for his defense and rebounding. Good shot blocker. Has work to do to develop on the offensive end of the floor. Shot 75% from the floor last season, but only scored 3.8 PPG. Will play a significant role for Illinois this season.
Alfonso Plummer	G	Super Sr.	6-1	182	Utah	Played his first two years at Arizona Western College, then transferred to Utah. Averaged 11.0 PPG in his two seasons at Utah while shooting 40% from 3 and 45% from the floor. Decent overall offensive player, but his biggest impact will be made behind the 3P line.

2021-22 Season Preview

- Unranked in all current “Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25” by CBS, Yahoo!, and ESPN.
- C Kofi Cockburn declared for the NBA Draft, but still has the option to come back to school. As of now it could turn out either way, but I am not including him on this Illini team yet.
- The Fighting Illini lost 5 players this offseason. G Ayo Dosunmu (NBA Draft) and C Kofi Cockburn (NBA Draft) were central pieces of last year’s team and it will be a struggle for Illinois to replace their production. G Adam Miller started every game of his freshman season, but shocked many when he announced he would transfer from the program (later committed to LSU).
- The Fighting Illini return 50% of their minutes played but only 38% of points scored from last season.
- Illinois currently has the 23rd ranked recruiting class for 2021 made up of 4-star forward Luke Goode, 4-star forward RJ Melendez, and 4-star guard Brandin Podziemski.
- The Illini are also adding 2 transfers who will immediately make an impact: G Alfonso Plummer and F Omar Payne.
- Illinois only has 4 players returning who are established and experienced players (Curbelo, Frazier, Williams, and Grandison), and even those guys have things to prove and room to develop. There are a lot of question marks on this roster. Illinois will look very different from the successful team of last year, and I see them finishing around the middle of the Big Ten.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Andre Curbelo Sophomore	Alfonso Plummer Super Senior	Trent Frazier Super Senior	Jacob Grandison RS - Senior	Omar Payne Junior
	Austin Hutcherson RS - Senior	Luke Goode Freshman	RJ Melendez Freshman	Coleman Hawkins Sophomore
	Brandin Podziemski Freshman	Da’Monte Williams Super Senior	Benjamin Bosmans-Verdonk RS - Sophomore	Brandon Lieb Sophomore

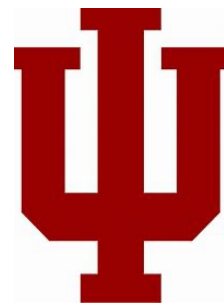
The Fighting Illini currently sit at 13 scholarship players, but Frazier and Williams don’t count against the limit, so they could give out 2 more scholarships if they choose to do so.



Indiana Hoosiers

Head Coach: Mike Woodson
(1st Season)

Simon Skjodt Assembly Hall
Bloomington, Indiana



Key Returning Players

Trayce Jackson-Davis	6'9"	F	19.1 PPG	34.3 MPG
Race Thompson	6'8"	F	9.1 PPG	28.1 MPG
Rob Phinisee	6'1"	G	7.1 PPG	27.1 MPG

Key Players Lost

Armaan Franklin	6'4"	G	11.4 PPG	30.1 MPG
Aljami Durham	6'4"	G	11.3 PPG	32.5 MPG
Jerome Hunter	6'7"	F	6.3 PPG	19.6 MPG

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 12-15 (7-12 B1G) for a T-10th place finish in the B1G. Finished the season on a 6-game losing streak. No NCAA appearance for the 4th consecutive season.
- Finished 67th in NET ranking, 50th in KenPom, and unranked in the final AP Poll or Coaches Poll.
- 2-11 Record in Quadrant I games.
- Trayce Jackson-Davis was named 3rd Team All-American by the NABC and 1st Team All-Big Ten. He was also named as a finalist for the Karl Malone Award. Trayce was the only high major player to average 19+ points and 9+ rebounds this season. Trayce led the Hoosiers in points, blocks, minutes played, FTM, FTA, and FG%.
- Armaan Franklin took a huge step forward this season and really helped the IU offense. After averaging 3.7 PPG his freshman year with 35/27/62 percentages, he greatly improved his sophomore year and put up 11.4 PPG with 43/42/74 percentages. He was the second most improved scorer in the Big Ten this season based on PPG. He did miss 7 games due to injury.
- Scored 69.7 PPG, 218th most in the nation. Finished 70th in adj. offensive efficiency (8th B1G).
- Played exclusively man defense (packline). Gave up 69.4 PPG, 147th fewest in the nation. Finished 43rd in adj. defensive efficiency (12th B1G).
- Pace of 65.9 rated 289th in the NCAA and 11th in the Big Ten.
- Ranked 8th nationally in free throw rate, but 300th nationally in free throw percentage.
- Poor shooting team: 43.3 FG% (214th) and 32.4 3P% (243rd). Only scored 25.2% of their points from 3, 307th highest nationally.

Offseason Timeline

- March 11** – Lost to Rutgers in the second round of the Big Ten Tournament to end their 2020-21 Season.
- March 15** – HC Archie Miller is fired.
- March 16** – G Aljami Durham enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Providence.
- March 23** – G Armaan Franklin enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Virginia.
- March 24** – F Race Thompson and G Parker Stewart enter the transfer portal.
- March 25** – F Jordan Geronimo enters the transfer portal.
- March 26** – G Khristian Lander enters the transfer portal.
- March 28** – Mike Woodson is announced as the next Head Coach. 4-star C Logan Duncomb announces that he remains committed to IU.
- March 31** – Kenya Hunter retained on staff as an Assistant Coach. G Parker Stewart withdraws from transfer portal.
- April 2** – F Trayce Jackson-Davis announces he will return to Indiana for his 3rd season.
- April 5** – Dane Fife (previously at Michigan State) is announced as an Assistant Coach. G Khristian Lander and F Jordan Geronimo withdraw from the transfer portal.
- April 7** – Former Pitt G Xavier Johnson commits to transfer to Indiana.
- April 8** – F Race Thompson withdraws from the transfer portal.
- April 13** – C Joey Brunk (who missed all season due to injury) announces he will transfer. Later commits to Ohio State.
- April 14** – Yasir Rosemond (previously at Alabama) is announced as an Assistant Coach.
- April 19** – 2021 4-star G Tamar Bates commits to Indiana.
- April 20** – Former Northwestern F Miller Kopp commits to transfer to Indiana.
- May 13** – F Jerome Hunter announces that he will not return to Indiana next season.
- May 17** – Former South Florida C Michael Durr commits to transfer to Indiana.

Returning Players

Player Information				2020-21 Season Stats								Notes	
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%		
#1 Rob Phinisee	G	Sr.	6-1	187	24/27	27.1	7.1	2.3	2.9	34.7%	26.0%	63.8%	Has averaged 6.8, 7.3, and 7.1 PPG in his first three seasons. Has never been a consistent offensive weapon. Scored 18 points (career high) in wins at Nebraska and at #4 Iowa last season. Just a 29.8% 3P shooter over his career, and coming off of his worst season at 26%. Boast over a 2:1 AST/TO ratio for his career. Will provide value to the Hoosiers this season with his perimeter defense and experience as a ball handler.
#3 Anthony Leal	G	So.	6-5	210	0/20	11.6	1.6	1.4	1.0	31.3%	30.0%	60.0%	Former 3-star recruit; 143rd ranked player in the 2020 class. Named as Indiana Mr. Basketball in 2020. Played sparingly his freshman year. His role was limited exclusively to a spot up 3P shooter (30/32 FGA last season were from 3). Finished the season 30% from 3. Is a big bodied guard and has good defensive potential.
#4 Khristian Lander	G	So.	6-2	185	0/26	10.1	2.1	0.8	1.2	25.7%	27.3%	87.5%	Former 5-star recruit; 27th ranked player in the 2020 class. Skipped his senior year of high school to reclassify and come to Indiana a year early. A very talented player whos strengths are his passing abilities and court vision. He led the team in assist rate last year, but those positives were negated by his extremely high turnover rate, inability to score the ball, and struggles on defense. The Hoosiers hope he can take a big step forward this season.
#22 Jordan Geronimo	F	So.	6-6	220	0/21	8.1	2.2	1.8	0.2	51.4%	40.0%	27.8%	Former 4-star recruit; 105th ranked player in the 2020 class. Gifted athlete. 6-6 with a 7-1 wingspan. Explosive jumping ability. Played inconsistent minutes during his freshman season, but was very effective in them. Shot 51% from the field and 40% from 3 (on limited attempts, but he looked comfortable enough taking them that he may be able to develop that skill). Great defensive and offensive potential because of his size and athleticism.
#23 Trayce Jackson Davis	F	Jr.	6-9	245	27/27	34.3	19.1	9.0	1.4	51.7%	N/A	65.5%	One of the best players in the nation last season. He took a step forward from what was considered a great freshman year. 2020-21 was assumed to be his final year at the college level, but even after his incredible numbers last season, he didn't show up on many draft boards due to his lack of versatility. Came back to Indiana after Coach Woodson promised to develop his right hand, jump shot, and overall offensive playmaking.
#25 Race Thompson	F	RS Sr.	6-8	228	27/27	28.1	9.1	6.2	1.4	51.5%	20.0%	61.4%	Thompson broke out last season with Joey Brunk on the bench for the year. He improved his scoring from 3.7 to 9.1 PPG, and was a great inside scorer. He got to the free throw line at a high rate, but was only able to convert those FT at a 61% rate. Great shot blocker and overall defensive player.
#32 Trey Galloway	G	So.	6-4	210	7/25	19.6	3.6	1.9	1.6	41.7%	18.2%	73.7%	Former 3-star recruit. Immediately made an impact for the Hoosiers and logged more than 20 minutes in 13 of his first 15 games. A back injury sidelined him for 2 games, and his minutes continued to fall until the end of the season after he returned. He is a physical player who thrives driving the ball to the rim and finishing or creating for others. His upside is limited by poor mid-range and 3P shooting (18% from 3). Will need to improve on that to provide value to IU next year.
#45 Parker Stewart	G	RS Sr.	6-5	200									Didn't play for the Hoosiers at all last year. Started 20 games as a freshman at Pitt. Averaged 9.1 PPG on 38.6% from 3P range. Transferred to UT-Martin and averaged 19.2 PPG. Shot 78% of his shots from 3 his freshman year, but that went down to 54% at UT-Martin.
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)				132.4 (64%)	43.7 (63%)	22.5 (65%)	9.1 (66%)						

New Players

	Position	Year	Height	Weight	Last School	Notes
#0 Xavier Johnson	G	Sr.	6-3	200	Pitt	Started 81 games in his 3 years at Pitt, and scored in double figures 66 of the 84 games he appeared in there. He had 5 or more assist in 45 of his 84 games. Career 34% 3P shooter. Has upped his assist numbers every season, averaging 5.7 per game his junior year. Will come in and make an immediate impact on this Hoosier team.
#12 Miller Kopp	F	Sr.	6-7	215	Northwestern	Started 74 of 87 possible games at Northwestern, including every game his sophomore and junior seasons. Averaged 13.1 and 11.3 PPG the last two years while shooting 40% and 33% from 3. Is an 85% FT shooter during his career. Has the 3P skills that this team desperately needed more of last season.
#51 Logan Duncomb	C	Fr.	6-9	235	Archbishop Moeller (OH)	4-star recruit; 69th rated player in the 2021 class. Old school big with great intangibles. Lacks great athleticism, but is physical enough to compete in the Big Ten. Averaged 13.5 PTS, 9.1 REB, 2.3 AST, and 1.3 BLK per game his senior year of high school while shooting 60% from the field. Will have to prove himself before earning a role his freshman year due to the talent already in the frontcourt in Bloomington.
#53 Tamar Bates	G	Fr.	6-5	180	IMG Academy (FL)	5-star recruit; 27th ranked player in the 2021 class. Often times the best player on a loaded IMG team. Thin build but lengthy for a combo guard. Good shooter who can also consistently get to the rim. Primarily a scorer, but capable at getting others involved. Has potential to be a elite defender. Has great lateral quickness and quick hands. Indiana has a lot of depth in the backcourt already, but he's talented enough to earn meaningful minutes early on in his career.
Michael Durr	C	Sr.	7-0	250	South Florida	Has averaged 24.3 MPG and 6.7 PPG in his 3 years at South Florida, with slight increases from year to year. Not an efficient scorer for his size/position. Has improved his FT% greatly, and shot 79% from there last season. Good rebounder, especially on the offensive end (top 100 nationally in both DREB and OREB %). Has shown ability to shoot from mid-range, but is a 17% 3P shooter for his career. Good rim protector on defense (top 200 in BLK%).

2021-22 Season Preview

- Unranked in all current “Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25” by CBS, Yahoo!, and ESPN.
- The Hoosiers lost 4 players this offseason: G Aljami Durham (transfer – Providence), G Armaan Franklin (transfer – Virginia), F Jerome Hunter, and C Joey Brunk (transfer – Ohio State). Brunk did not play in 2020-21.
- The Hoosiers return 64% of their minutes played and 63% of points scored from last season.
- Indiana currently has the 35th ranked recruiting class for 2021 made up of 5-star guard Tamar Bates and 4-star center Logan Duncomb.
- Indiana is also adding 3 experienced transfers who will immediately make an impact: F Miller Kopp, G Xavier Johnson, and C Michael Durr.
- This will be HC Mike Woodson’s first year coaching at the college level. The Hoosiers won’t be looking at a long rebuild though as they have the talent to compete in the Big Ten. Coach Woodson has talked about wanting to play a “4-out 1-in” style this season. Now that there is better offensive talent around Jackson-Davis, look for them to be in that second tier of Big Ten teams.
- Indiana has a good mix of talented veterans and young prospects with high potential. They should be a team that finishes in the top half of the Big Ten and makes an NCAAT appearance.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Rob Phinisee Senior	Xavier Johnson Senior	Miller Kopp Senior	Race Thompson RS - Senior	Trayce Jackson-Davis Junior
Khristian Lander Sophomore	Tamar Bates Freshman	Trey Galloway Sophomore	Jordan Geronimo Sophomore	Michael Durr Senior
	Anthony Leal Sophomore	Parker Stewart RS - Senior		Logan Duncomb Freshman

The Hoosiers are at the limit of 13 scholarship players for this season.



Iowa Hawkeyes

Head Coach: Fran McCaffery
(12th Season, 216-152)

Carver-Hawkeye Arena
Iowa City, Iowa



Key Returning Players

Jordan Bohannon 6'1" G 10.6 PPG 29.2 MPG

Keegan Murray 6'8" F 7.2 PPG 18.0 MPG

Key Players Lost

Luka Garza 6'11" C 24.1 PPG 31.5 MPG

Joe Wieskamp* 7'0" C 14.8 PPG 29.3 MPG

CJ Fredrick 6'3" G 7.5 PPG 24.7 MPG

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 22-9 (14-6 B1G) for a 3rd place finish in the B1G (Best since 2015-16). Fifth NCAAT appearance under Coach McCaffery. Earned a 2 seed, lost to Oregon in the Round of 32.
- Finished 7th in NET ranking, 7th in KenPom, 8th in the final AP Poll, and 13th in the final Coaches Poll.
- 7-7 Record in Quadrant I games.
- Luka Garza won the Naismith Trophy, AP College Basketball Player of the Year, Oscar Robertson Trophy, Big Ten Men's Basketball Player of the Year, and was a unanimous consensus First Team All-American. He led the NCAA this season in PER, points scored, 30-point games, 20-point games, and FGs made. He leaves the program as Iowa's all-time leading scorer, and 7th leading scorer in Big Ten history.
- Joe Wieskamp was named to the All-Big Ten Second Team and was a finalist for the Jerry West Award. He was the only player in the nation with 400+ points, 200+ rebounds, 70+ 3P made, and 25+ steals. He scored in double figures 27 times out of 31 games this season and was the second leading scorer on the team.
- Scored 83.7 PPG, 5th most in the nation. Finished 3rd in adj. offensive efficiency (1st B1G).
- Played man defense 95% of possessions. Gave up 72.7 PPG, 246th fewest in the nation. Finished 75th in adj. defensive efficiency (7th B1G).
- Pace of 69.9 rated 93rd in the NCAA and 4th in the Big Ten.
- Able to play defense without fouling: 6th lowest foul rate nationally.
- On offense, they took care of the ball and made 3s. Lowest turnover rate in the nation (13.3%) and 10th best 3P% in the nation (38.6%). They had 3 players shoot higher than 44% from 3 on the season with at least 75 3PA. They also had the 4th highest assist rate nationally.

Offseason Timeline

- March 22** – Lost to Oregon 95-80 in the Round of 32.
- March 25** – Walk-on G Austin Ash enters the transfer portal.
- March 30** – F Jack Nunge enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Xavier.
- April 10** – 2022 3-star recruit Riley Mulvey announces he will reclassify to the 2021 class and join the Hawkeyes this summer.
- April 14** – G/F Joe Wieskamp declares for the NBA Draft but will still remain eligible to possibly return to Iowa.
- April 19** – G CJ Fredrick enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Kentucky.
- April 22** – Former North Dakota F Filip Rebraca commits to transfer to Iowa.
- April 26** – G Jordan Bohannon announces that he will return to Iowa to use his extra year of eligibility.
- April 29** – G Austin Ash withdraws from the transfer portal and announces that he will return to Iowa as a scholarship player.

Returning Players

Player Information					2020-21 Season Stats									Notes
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%			
#1 Joe Toussaint	G	Jr.	6-0	190	0/31	11.3	3.7	1.2	2.4	42.4%	27.3%	62.2%	Played in all 62 out of 62 possible games his first two seasons, and started 20 games his freshman year. His minutes went down from 18 to 11 per game from his freshman to sophomore seasons due to his turnover problems and inability to space the floor (27% 3p). This led to his PPG dropping from 6.5 to 3.7. He is a tough defender, can penetrate and dish the ball on offense, and loves to push it in transition. He will be expected to take on a much larger role this year.	
#3 Jordan Bohannon	G	RS Super Sr.	6-1	175	31/31	29.2	10.6	3.1	4.4	38.9%	39.0%	88.9%	Is returning for his 6th season at Iowa. Career 11.5 PPG scorer on 40% from 3P range and 89% from the FT line. Had the highest 3PA rate of his career last season with 80% of his FGA coming from 3. Led the Hawkeyes in assist last season. Its pretty safe to expect him to impact the team in the same way he has for year now.	
#4 Ahron Ullis	G	So.	6-2	175	0/17	7.0	1.6	0.9	1.2	33.3%	0.0%	90.0%	Former 3-star recruit. Played double digit minutes in 6 games his freshman season. Point guard who showed flashes as a playmaker for others. With Bohannon returning, he won't play as big of a role as he may have been expecting, but Iowa will still need him to contribute this season.	
#11 Tony Perkins	G	So.	6-4	185	0/24	6.1	1.6	1.3	0.7	45.5%	33.3%	46.7%	Former 3-star recruit. Played double digit minutes in 6 games his freshman season. Shooting guard who brings defensive energy. Bohannon's return will likley take a lot of the minutes he was expecting to play this season, but he is going to bring energy and make plays off the bench for Iowa this year.	
#13 Austin Ash	G	RS Sr.	6-2	160	0/9	2.3	1.7	0.4	0.2	40.0%	33.3%	N/A	Former walk-on. Has played 3.2 MPG in his 26 game appearances in his 3 seasons at Iowa. Was planning on transferring this offseason, but withdrew from the portal when Iowa offered him a scholarship. Is known strictly as a 3p shooter (80% of his attempts come from 3). Will likely be a deep reserve for the Hawkeyes this year.	
#15 Keegan Murray	F	So.	6-8	215	4/31	18.0	7.2	5.1	0.5	50.6%	29.6%	75.5%	Former 3-star recruit. Earned All-Big Ten Freshman team selection. Was the only bench player in the nation to have 200+ points, 35+ blocks, 25+ steals, and 15+ 3P made. Does a little bit of everything on the court. He is expected to take a big step forward this season and step into the role of one of the Hawkeyes best players.	
#20 Kris Murray	F	So.	6-8	205	0/13	3.2	0.6	0.6	0.1	23.1%	0.0%	100.0%	Former 3-star recruit. Played 42 minutes total his freshman season. Will be given opportunities to play for this inexperienced Hawkeye team, but it is unclear how much he will be able to provide for them.	
#22 Patrick McCaffery	F	RS So.	6-9	190	0/31	14.6	5.2	2.7	0.9	43.8%	30.2%	70.7%	Former 4-star recruit; 86th ranked player in the 2019 class. Played in all 31 games last year after missing all but 2 games the year prior. Can score at the rim and make plays in transition. Showed flashes of perimeter scoring, but needs to improve on that still. Long player who fits well into their defense. Expected to play a bigger role this season.	
#23 Josh Ogundele	F	So.	6-11	245	0/8	2.1	0.9	1.0	0.0	50.0%	N/A	25.0%	Former 3-star recruit. Totaled 17 minutes of playing time his freshman season. Raw big man with good potential because of his athleticism. There is a hole at the C position for the Hawkeyes, so if he develops well this offseason, he could be in line for some meaningful minutes this year.	
#30 Connor McCaffery	G	RS Sr.	6-5	200	31/31	22.8	3.3	3.1	3.6	32.4%	27.7%	58.6%	2 sport athlete for Iowa (basketball and baseball). Started all 31 games, and finished 2nd on the team in assist last season. Very high IQ player. Poor 3P and FT shooter. Has nearly a 4.1 Ast/TO ratio for his career. Tore labrums on both sides of his hips last season and had surgery during the offseason. Is expected to be medically cleared for all activities in October.	
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)					107.0 (53%)	33.1 (40%)	17.3 (44%)	13.1 (68%)						

New Players

Position		Year	Height	Weight	Last School	Notes
Riley Mulvey	C	Fr.	6-11	230	St. Thomas More (CT)	3-star recruit; 204th ranked player in the 2021 class. Redclassified from the 2022 class to join Iowa a year early. Big bodied center who continued to rise up the recruiting rankings while continuing to grow throughout high school. Good rebounder and rim protector who can jump well for his size. Needs to continue to fill out his frame to be able to consistently compete with Big Ten post players.
Filip Rebraca	F	Sr.	6-9	222	North Dakota	Started 74 games in his 3 years at North Dakota. Has the ability to play in the post, face up, and guard multiple positions. Can convert from 3P range (36.6% last season).
Payton Sandfort	C	Fr.	6-7	210	Waukee HS (IA)	3-star recruit; 174th ranked player in the 2021 class. Considered a prototypical Fran McCaffery recruit. A long player who is an excellent shooter from 3P range.

2021-22 Season Preview

- Unranked in all current “Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25” by CBS, Yahoo!, and ESPN.
- G/F Joe Wieskamp has declared for the NBA Draft. While it is still possible for him to return to school next year, I do not expect him to.
- The Hawkeyes lost 4 players this offseason. C Luka Garza and G/F Joe Wieskamp both left for the NBA Draft. G CJ Fredrick and F Jack Nunge were both expected to be big part of this year’s team, but both decided to transfer instead.
- The Hawkeyes return 53% of their minutes played but only 40% of points scored from last season. However, they are returning their top 3 players in assist and APG from last season.
- Iowa currently has the 66th ranked recruiting class for 2021 made up of 3-star center Payton Sandfort and 3-star center Riley Mulvey.
- The Hawkeyes are also adding transfer F Filip Rebraca from North Dakota.
- Iowa had a successful season last year, but after the departure of Luka Garza, there is a huge hole to fill. He is the program’s all-time leader in points scored, and they have run the offense through him for years now. This season, the Hawkeyes may struggle to score, but they have a lot of good young defenders that will take on larger roles. This season will be about developing young guys, and even with the few talented veterans they have coming back, they will likely finish in the bottom half of the Big Ten.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Joe Toussaint Junior	Jordan Bohannon RS – Super Senior	Patrick McCaffery RS - Sophomore	Keegan Murray Sophomore	Filip Rebraca Senior
Ahron Ulis Sophomore	Tony Perkins Sophomore	Connor McCaffery RS - Senior	Payton Sandfort Freshman	Josh Ogundele Sophomore
	Austin Ash RS - Senior		Kris Murray Sophomore	Riley Mulvey Freshman

Iowa currently has 13 scholarship players, but Bohannon doesn’t count towards the limit, so they could bring in one more if they want.



Maryland Terrapins

Head Coach: Mark Turgeon
(11th Season, 221-113)

Xfinity Center
College Park, Maryland



Key Returning Players

Eric Ayala*	6'5"	G	15.1 PPG	33.6 MPG
Donta Scott	6'7"	F	11.0 PPG	30.3 MPG
Hakim Hart	6'6"	G	7.1 PPG	25.5 MPG

Key Players Lost

Aaron Wiggins*	6'6"	G	14.5 PPG	33.0 MPG
Darryl Morsell*	6'5"	G	9.0 PPG	29.4 MPG
Jairus Hamilton	6'8"	F	6.5 PPG	20.5 MPG

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 17-14 (9-11 B1G) for a T-8th place finish in the B1G (worst since joining in 2014). Fifth NCAAT appearance in the last six seasons. Earned a 10 seed, lost to Alabama in the Round of 32.
- Finished 38th in NET ranking, 35th in KenPom, and unranked in the final AP Poll or Coaches Poll.
- 5-11 Record in Quadrant I games and 2-3 record in Quadrant II games.
- G Aaron Wiggins and G Darryl Morsell both earned a spot on the honorable mention All-Big Ten team. They were the top two players on the team in minutes played, points scored, assist, steals, and 3P made.
- G Darryl Morsell was voted Big Ten Defensive Player of the Year as well as honorable mention All-Big Ten. Along with having an outstanding season on defense, he averaged career highs in PPG, APG, and FG%.
- Scored 68.9 PPG, 240th most in the nation. Finished 37th in adj. offensive efficiency (11th B1G).
- Played man defense 93% of possessions. Gave up 65.6 PPG, 55th fewest in the nation. Finished 42nd in adj. defensive efficiency (5th B1G).
- Pace of 64.7 rated 321st in the NCAA and 13th in the Big Ten.
- Only had an offensive rebound rate of 20.6%, 28th worst in the nation.
- Didn't put opponents at the free throw line often; 34th lowest foul rate in the nation.
- Take 43% of their FGs from 3P range, 44th highest rate nationally. Allow opponents to take 42% of their shots from 3P range, and opponents score 38% of their points from 3P shots, 15th highest rate nationally.

Offseason Timeline

- **March 22** – Lost to Alabama 96-77 in the Round of 32.
- **March 31** – C Chol Marial enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Oregon State.
- **April 3** – Former Rhode Island G Fats Russell and former Georgetown F Qudus Wahab commit to transfer to Maryland.
- **April 5** – G Darryl Morsell declares for the NBA Draft and enters the transfer portal to keep options open.
- **April 8** – G Aquan Smart enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Florida International.
- **April 9** – G Eric Ayala and G Aaron Wiggins both declare for the NBA Draft but will still remain eligible to possibly return to Maryland.
- **April 16** – Assistant Coach DeAndre Haynes announces that he will be leaving Maryland to take a job at Marquette.
- **April 20** – F Jairus Hamilton enters the transfer portal. Former Utah G Ian Martinez commits to transfer to Maryland.
- **April 21** – Danny Manning (previously at Wake Forest) is announced as an Assistant Coach.
- **May 6** – G Aaron Wiggins hires an NCAA approved agent but is still remaining eligible to return to Maryland.

Returning Players

Player Information		2020-21 Season Stats											Notes
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%		
#0 Marcus Dockery	G	So.	6-2	180	0/14	3.6	1.4	0.3	0.1	77.8%	60.0%	40.0%	Former 3-star recruit; 225th ranked player in the 2020 class. Played 51 minutes in 14 games as a freshman. Has a quick release and range that goes beyond the 3P line. Most effective as the off ball guard. Good catch and shoot player who can also attack closeouts and finish at the rim. Good at using screens. Plays passing lanes well on defense.
#1 James Graham III	G/F	So.	6-8	205	0/8	4.5	1.3	1.3	0.1	36.4%	22.2%	N/A	Former 4-star recruit; 127th ranked player in the 2020 class. Was a part of the 2021 class until he decided to reclassify and join the Terps midseason. Lengthy and smooth athlete, but lacks explosiveness Played 36 minutes in 8 games. Took 9 of his 11 shots from 3P range. Good shooting stroke, especially off the dribble. Can guard multiple positions, but doesn't play with enough physicality on defense yet.
#5 Eric Ayala	G	Sr.	6-5	200	28/29	33.6	15.1	4.3	2.2	43.7%	33.7%	83.1%	Scored 8.6 and 8.5 PPG his freshman and sophomore seasons, but jumped to 15.1 his junior year. Career 34% 3P shooter. Averaged 1.2 steals/game his junior year after only averaging .4/game his first two years. If he comes back to Maryland for another season, he will need to improve his jump-shooting consistency, off ball offensive play, defensive focus, and show he can guard good players if he wants to improve his draft stock for the 2022 draft.
#13 Hakim Hart	G	Jr.	6-6	205	19/31	25.5	7.1	3.5	1.9	45.2%	33.0%	76.0%	Had a quiet freshman season where he played 6.2 MPG in 18 games, scoring 1.6 PPG. Started 19 games last season, some at PG and some at SG. Improved on all of his shooting percentages and scored 7.1 PPG, good for 5th on the team. Had over a 2:1 AST/TO ratio last year. Struggled offensively to end the season, but still made an impact with his great defense.
#24 Donta Scott	F	Jr.	6-7	230	27/31	30.3	11.0	5.9	2.0	49.8%	43.8%	66.3%	Athletic combo forward. Started 21 games as a freshman, scoring 5.9 PPG. Played over 30 MPG last year and started 27 games. Upped his scoring to 11.0 PPG while increasing his 3P% from 32 to 44 percent from year 1 to year 2 (best on the team). Will have the chance to be the best player on this team, depending on who returns, and get drafted in 2022. Projects to be a 3-and-D guy in the NBA.
#31 Arnaud Revaz	F	So.	6-10	215	0/5	3.2	0.6	1.2	0.2	33.3%	N/A	50.0%	Was a track and field athlete, who specialized in high jump, until he started playing basketball at the age of 15. Rarely saw the court his freshman year. Skilled big man who is a natural athlete. Can shoot 3s, dribble, pass, and score with both hands around the rim. Still not known if he has developed enough to impact the game at the Big Ten level this season.
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)					90.7 (45%)	33.4 (48%)	14.1 (43%)	6.1 (46%)					

New Players

	Position	Year	Height	Weight	Last School	Notes
#4 Fatts Russell	G	Super Sr.	5-11	165	Rhode Island	Played in 119 games in 4 years at Rhode Island, and has been a starter since his sophomore year. Played over 33 MPG each of his last 3 seasons. Had a good season from 3P range his junior year, but for his whole career he shoots the 3 at 28%. Is a complete player who can do a little bit of everything. He was usually the primary scorer at URI, something he won't have to do at Maryland. This should allow him to make more of an impact everywhere else. Will also be a good addition to the Terps defense.
#23 Ian Martinez	G	So.	6-3	183	Utah	Former 4-star recruit; 120th ranked player in the 2020 class. Explosive athlete, but has a narrow frame that he needs to add strength to. His father was an assistant coach at Utah when the HC got fired, so Martinez decided to transfer. Played a reserve role in 25 games as a freshman, scoring 5.2 PPG. He scored in double figures 5 of the last 10 games of the season. Inconsistent shooter, but can score at all 3 levels. Has good playmaking abilities as a 2 guard. His physical tools give him high defensive upside.
#33 Qudus Wahab	F	Jr.	6-11	237	Georgetown	Started 7 games his freshman year and 25 games last year. A strong, physical, inside player. Great rebounder and good shot blocker. His scoring potential is limited to around the rim. Turns the ball over too much (2.0/game). Shots FTs at a decent percentage for his size (66%). Limited defensively because he can't guard quicker guys out on the perimeter.
Ike Cornish	G/F	Fr.	6-6	185	Legacy Charter (SC)	4-star recruit; 107th ranked player in the 2021 class. Long player who will need to add muscle to his frame. Elite quickness and jumping abilities. He's at his best when driving to finish at the rim. Typically plays under control and doesn't force bad decisions. Has very high defensive potential due to his athleticism, length, and versatility.
Julian Reese	F	Fr.	6-9	230	St. Frances Academy (MD)	4-star recruit; 56th ranked player in the 2021 class. Strong, physical player who has recently developed explosive athleticism. Highly mobile big man. Has multiple skills on offense including a good face up game. Good defender and shot blocker.

2021-22 Season Preview

- Rankings in "Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25": #4 (Yahoo!), #13 (CBS), #10 (ESPN).
- Maryland is still waiting on decisions from 3 key guys. G Darryl Morsell (NBA Draft, transfer portal) likely won't get drafted, but is still as good as gone, even though he technically still has the option to come back. G Eric Ayala (NBA Draft) will likely return to school, but it is not a guarantee. G Aaron Wiggins (NBA Draft) is truly difficult to predict. It could go either way, but I am expecting him to go pro until proven otherwise.
- The Terps lost 7 players this offseason, 4 of which were regular rotation players. G Aaron Wiggins and G Darryl Morsell were critical pieces to this team but are planning on going pro. F Galin Smith graduated while F Jairus Hamilton decided to transfer.
- The Terrapins return 45% of their minutes played and 48% of points scored from last season.
- Maryland currently has the 46th ranked recruiting class for 2021 made up of 4-star forward Julian Reese and 4-star guard/forward Ike Cornish.
- The Terps were active early in the transfer market, landing G Fatts Russell, C Qudus Wahab, and G Ian Martinez.
- Maryland has one of the more talented teams that Coach Turgeon has ever had. They will be good all-around but should excel defensively. They still have two more roster spots to fill in some needed depth, but they have an upper tier Big Ten team that will be further elevated if Wiggins decides to come back.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Fatts Russell Super Senior	Eric Ayala Senior	Donta Scott Junior	James Graham III Sophomore	Qudus Wahab Junior
Hakim Hart Sophomore	Ian Martinez Sophomore	Ike Cornish Freshman	Julian Reese Freshman	Arnaud Revaz Sophomore
	Marcus Dockery Sophomore			

The Terrapins have 11 scholarship players currently and will be looking to use their last two scholarships to find some depth.



Michigan Wolverines

Head Coach: Juwan Howard
(3rd Season, 42-17)

Crisler Center
Ann Arbor, Michigan



Key Returning Players

Hunter Dickinson	7'1"	C	14.1 PPG	26.0 MPG
Eli Brooks	6'1"	G	9.5 PPG	31.1 MPG

Key Players Lost

Franz Wagner	6'9"	G	12.5 PPG	31.7 MPG
Isaiah Livers	6'7"	F	13.1 PPG	31.6 MPG
Mike Smith	5'11"	G	9.0 PPG	31.6 MPG

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 23-5 (14-3 B1G) for a 1st place finish in the B1G (First time since 2013-14). 5th consecutive NCAAT appearance. #1 seed; lost in the Elite Eight to UCLA.
- Finished 3rd in NET ranking, 3rd in KenPom, 4th in the final AP Poll, and 4th in the final Coaches Poll.
- 10-3 Record in Quadrant I games.
- HC Juwan Howard won Big Ten Coach of the Year and AP Coach of the Year.
- Hunter Dickinson won Big Ten Freshman of the Year, was named to the All-Big Ten first team, and was selected as All-American Second Team by the AP (among others). He also was a semifinalist for the Naismith Trophy, the Wooden Award, and the Kareem Abdul-Jabbar Award. Dickinson led the Wolverines in points, rebounds, and blocks this season. He finished in the top 150 players nationally in offensive and defensive rebound rate, block rate, and 2P FG%.
- Franz Wagner was named one of the final 10 candidates for the Basketball Hall of Fame Jerry West Award. He was also one of the 16 players named on the Naismith Defensive Player of the Year watchlist.
- Isaiah Livers was named as one of the final 10 candidates for the Basketball Hall of Fame Julius Erving Award. He was also named as Big Ten Player of the Week in January. Missed the final 5 games of the season due to a stress fracture in his foot.
- Scored 75.8 PPG, 68th most in the nation. Finished 9th in adj. offensive efficiency (4th B1G).
- Played man defense on 94% of possessions. Gave up 65.1 PPG, 47th fewest in the nation. Finished 4th in adj. defensive efficiency (1st B1G).
- Pace of 66.6 rated 256th in the NCAA and 10th in the Big Ten.
- Forced teams into turnovers on only 14.8% of possessions (336th in the NCAA), but only allowed a 44.4% eFG rate (6th in the nation). Opponents' possessions lasted an average of 18.1 seconds, 321st longest in the NCAA.
- Shot 38.1% from 3 (13th), but only 33.9% of their FGA were from 3 (261st highest). Had 3 players (Smith, Livers, and Brown) shoot above 40% from 3 on the season.
- Only 25% of their minutes were played by players off the bench, which is 303rd most nationally.

Offseason Timeline

- March 30** – Lost to UCLA 49-51 in the Elite Eight.
- April 7** – G Mike Smith announces he will not return for his extra year of eligibility and will instead declare for the NBA Draft.
- April 10** – G Chaundee Brown announces he will not return for his extra year of eligibility and will instead declare for the NBA Draft.
- April 14** – F Austin Davis announces he will not return for his extra year of eligibility. G Eli Brooks announces that he will return to Michigan to use his extra year of eligibility.
- April 16** – F Isaiah Livers announces he will not return for his extra year of eligibility and will instead declare for the NBA Draft.
- May 1** – Former Coastal Carolina G DeVante' Jones commits to transfer to Michigan but says he will still look to test NBA Draft waters.
- May 4** – G Franz Wagner declares for the NBA Drafts with plans of hiring an agent.

Returning Players

Player Information				2020-21 Season Stats								Notes	
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%		
#0 Adrien Nunez	G	Sr.	6-6	210	0/10	3.4	0.6	0.4	0.0	33.3%	0.0%	N/A	Played in 20 and 22 games his freshman and sophomore seasons, but only 10 his junior year. Played no on-court role last year and not expected to this year either.
#1 Hunter Dickinson	C	So.	7-1	255	23/28	26.0	14.1	7.4	0.9	59.8%	0.0%	73.9%	Former 4-star recruit; 43rd ranked player in the 2020 class. Came into Michigan and made an immediate impact and was one of the best players in the Big Ten. Scored in double figures in 23 of 28 games this season. Has not yet said whether or not he will return to Michigan for his sophomore season, but many expect him to. 7-1 center who occupies space and rebounds very well. Shot 74% from the free throw line. Would highly raise UM's ceiling this season should he return.
#3 Zeb Jackson	G	So.	6-5	180	0/16	5.3	1.0	0.8	0.4	19.2%	15.4%	57.1%	Former 4-star recruit; 96th ranked player in the 2020 class. Only played 10 minutes or more in one game this season (vs Ball State). Scored 16 points on the season. Was considered a combo guard out of high school, but was put at the point guard spot his freshman year. Has the athleticism to be a 2 or 3. With Frankie Collins and DeVante Jones joining the team, I would look for him to see the court much as a point guard.
#5 Terrance Williams II	F	So.	6-7	240	0/21	7.6	1.9	2.2	0.4	35.9%	7.1%	55.0%	Former 4-star recruit; 101st ranked player in the 2020 class. Played in 21 games as a freshman. Physical and tough forward. Not an explosive athlete, but has good hands and feet. Showed potential as a floor spacing big coming out of high school, but only shot 1/14 from 3 his freshman year. Versatile defender.
#23 Brandon Johns Jr.	F	Sr.	6-8	240	5/28	12.9	4.9	2.3	0.5	52.7%	36.8%	79.5%	Former 4-star recruit; 70th ranked player in the 2018 class. Played sparingly in 28 games as a freshman. Took on a much larger role his sophomore year, playing 19.5 MPG in 30 games. Didn't play much his junior year until Livers was injured and Johns was cast into a starting role. Showed lots of potential. Very athletic player. Efficient scorer from everywhere on the floor. With the Wolverines losing so many forwards from last season, Johns is expected to have a role this season.
#25 Jace Howard	G	So.	6-7	210	0/11	3.1	1.1	0.4	0.0	42.9%	50.0%	50.0%	Played sparingly in 11 games this season. Son of HC Juwan Howard. Played no on court role last year and not expected to this year either.
#55 Eli Brooks	G	Super Sr.	6-1	185	27/27	31.1	9.5	3.1	3.1	42.6%	39.6%	90.0%	Opted to use his extra year of eligibility to play his 5th season at UM this year. His freshman and sophomore years he averaged 1.8 and 2.5 PPG, but then averaged 10.6 and 9.5 PPG his junior and senior years. Known as a very high IQ player. Shot 36% and 40% from 3 his last two seasons. Had roughly a 3:1 AST/TO ratio last year.
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)				80.1 (40%)	30.8 (41%)	15.1 (40%)	4.9 (31%)						

New Players

Position	Year	Height	Weight	Last School	Notes	
Isalah Barnes	G/F	Fr.	6-7	195	Simeon Career Academy (IL)	4-star recruit; 110th ranked player in the 2021 class. A long, athletic wing. Projected to be a 3-and-D type player at the next level. Good ball handler who can attack the rim, but his offensive game is predicated on his pull up jump shot.
Kobe Bufkin	G	Fr.	6-4	185	Grand Rapids Christian HS (MI)	4-star recruit; 42nd ranked player in the 2021 class. McDonald's All-American. Combo guard who is more of a two than a one. Explosive athlete who plays the game very smoothly and in control. Great footwork and body control. Good finisher at the rim. Needs to add some weight to his frame. Excellent defender.
Frankie Collins	G	Fr.	6-1	180	Coronado HS (NV)	4-star recruit; 43rd ranked player in the 2021 class. Extremely athletic point guard who excels at creating for himself and others in a ball screen offense. Finishes around the rim very well for his size, and has shown some potential with his 3P shot, but will need to prove it can be consistent at the next level.
Moussa Diabate	F	Fr.	6-10	220	IMG Academy (FL)	5-star recruit; 13th ranked player in the 2021 class. McDonald's All-American. High level rebounder with very limited shooting range. High energy player who thrives on contact. Good defender and quality shot blocker. Will make an impact with his defense and rebounding.
Caleb Houston	G/F	Fr.	6-8	205	Montverde Academy (FL)	5-star recruit; 7th ranked player in the 2021 class. Reclassified from the 2022 class and will skip his senior season of HS to join the Wolverines this year. McDonald's All-American. A long and lean stretch 4. Great catch and shoot abilities, and can put the ball on the floor to get to the rim as well. Highest rated recruit at Michigan since Glenn Robinson III. Expected to start for the Wolverines.
DeVante' Jones	G	RS Sr.	6-1	200	Costal Carolina	Sun Belt Player of the Year. One of the top available point guards in the transfer portal. Redshirted his first year, then started 77 games in his next 3 years at Costal Carolina. Improved his scoring each year, and scored 19.3 PPG as a redshirt junior. Career 33% 3P shooter and 86% from the FT line. Improved his rebounding numbers each year, up to 7.2 RPG his last year. Produced 5.7 APG his RS So. year, but fell to 2.9 APG his RS Jr. year, which was lowest of his career.
Will Tschetter	F	Fr.	6-8	235	Stewartville HS (MN)	3-star recruit; 139th ranked player in the 2021 class. Played at a small high school and never played on the AAU circuit. Has a great jumpshot when his feet are set and he is open. Projects to be a pick-and-pop big man at the Big Ten level.

2021-22 Season Preview

- Rankings in "Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25": #2 (Yahoo!), #6 (CBS), #11 (ESPN).
- The Wolverines lost a lot of talent from their Elite Eight team last year. They have lost G Franz Wagner, F Isaiah Livers, G Mike Smith, and G Chaundee Brown to the NBA Draft. They also lost 5th year senior Austin Brown. This accounts for 5 of their 8 players that played prominent roles for them last season.
- The Wolverines return 40% of their minutes played and 41% of points scored from last season.
- Michigan currently has the 1st ranked recruiting class for 2021 headlined by 5-star forward Caleb Houston and 5-star F Moussa Diabate. They also are bringing in three 4-star players and one 3-star player.
- As well as their deep freshman class, Michigan is adding experienced G DeVante' Jones from Costal Carolina.
- Even though Michigan lost so many crucial pieces from their team last year, they aren't looking to take a step back. They are bringing in 7 new players and expect most of them to have a big impact. They also are bringing back Eli Brooks as a "Super Senior". This team will expect to be championship contenders both in the Big Ten and nationally.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
DeVante' Jones RS - Senior	Eli Brooks Super Senior	Caleb Houston Freshman	Brandon Johns Jr. Senior	Hunter Dickinson Sophomore
Frankie Collins Freshman	Kobe Bufkin Freshman	Isaiah Barnes Freshman	Will Tschetter Freshman	Moussa Diabate Freshman
	Zeb Jackson Sophomore		Terrance Williams II Sophomore	

The Wolverines are at 13 scholarships right now (with Brooks not counting toward limit). There have been rumors of Jace Howard vacating his scholarship and playing as a walk on. This would open up one more scholarship for UM.



Michigan State Spartans

Head Coach: Tom Izzo
(27th Season, 643-254)

Breslin Center
East Lansing, Michigan



Key Returning Players

Joey Hauser	6'9"	F	9.7 PPG	21.5 MPG
Gabe Brown	6'8"	F	7.2 PPG	20.7 MPG
Malik Hall	6'7"	F	5.0 PPG	17.5 MPG

Key Players Lost

Aaron Henry	6'6"	F	15.4 PPG	32.5 MPG
Joshua Langford	6'5"	G	9.7 PPG	28.0 MPG
Rocket Watts	6'2"	G	7.7 PPG	22.6 MPG

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 15-13 (9-11 B1G) for a T-8th place finish in the B1G (Worst in Izzo era). 23rd consecutive NCAAT appearance. Were ranked as high as #4 in the AP Poll this year. Earned an 11 seed, lost to UCLA in the First Four.
- Finished 76th in NET ranking, 64th in KenPom, and unranked in the final AP Poll or Coaches Poll.
- 5-11 Record in Quadrant I games.
- F Aaron Henry was selected to the All-Big Ten Third Team as well as the Big Ten All-Defensive Team. On the season, he led MSU in scoring, assist, steals, and minutes played while finishing second in rebounding and blocks. He was one of only two players in D1 basketball to average 15+ points, 5.5+ rebounds, 3.5+ assist, and 1.3+ blocks.
- Scored 69.4 PPG, 230th most in the nation. Finished 98th in adj. offensive efficiency (13th B1G).
- Played exclusively man defense. Gave up 71.1 PPG, 202nd fewest in the nation. Finished 45th in adj. defensive efficiency (8th B1G).
- Pace of 68.3 rated 164th in the NCAA and 9th in the Big Ten.
- Poor shooting team (257th in eFG%) who don't like to take 3s (34% of FGA were from 3P range; 257th highest rate).
- Assisted on 63.7% of their FG made, 6th highest rate in the nation.
- Don't force many turnovers on defense (333rd highest rate nationally) and put opponents at the FT line frequently (293rd highest rate).

Offseason Timeline

- **March 18** – Lost to UCLA 86-80 in the First Four.
- **March 24** – G Jack Hoiberg enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to UT-Arlington.
- **March 27** – Former Northeastern G Tyson Walker commits to transfer to Michigan State.
- **March 29** – G Rocket Watts enters the transfer portal.
- **April 5** – Assistant Coach Dane Fife announces that he will be leaving Michigan State to take a job at Indiana.
- **April 12** – F Aaron Henry declares for the NBA Draft and signs an agent.
- **April 13** – Former recruiting coordinator Doug Wojcik is promoted to Assistant Coach. F Thomas Kithier enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Valparaiso.
- **April 19** – G Joshua Langford announces that he will not return to Michigan State for another season and that his basketball career is over. G Foster Loyer enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Davidson.
- **April 30** – 2022 #1 overall recruit Emoni Bates decommits from Michigan State.

Returning Players

Player Information				2020-21 Season Stats								Notes	
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%		
#11 A.J. Hoggard	G	So.	6-3	220	8/26	13.2	2.5	1.9	2.0	30.7%	16.7%	60.0%	Former 4-star recruit; 81st ranked player in the 2020 class. Started 8 games as a freshman. Big frame for a point guard. Good at getting others involved. Uses a physical style of play and tight handles to get to the rim at will. Shot poorly from 3 (17%). Good defender on the perimeter. Will have competition for minutes with newcomers Tyson Walker and Jaden Adkins.
#20 Joey Hauser	F	RS Jr.	6-9	220	16/28	21.5	9.7	5.6	1.4	47.5%	34.0%	72.1%	Played one season at Marquette, then sat out a year due to transfer rules before playing for Michigan State. Started off the season strong for the Spartans, including a 27 pt performance vs Wisconsin. His play decreased as the season progressed though, and he started losing minutes to Malik Hall. Hauser averaged 9.7 PPG both of his years, but his 2p% rose by 14% last year while his 3P% fell by 9%. He will compete with Hall for minutes at the 4 spot again this year.
#22 Mady Sissoko	C	So.	6-9	235	0/25	5.4	1.1	1.8	0.0	58.8%	N/A	43.8%	Former 4-star recruit; 41st ranked player in the 2020 class. Known for playing with outstanding energy. Is a little short compared to centers in the Big Ten, but makes up for it with his 7-4 wingspan and elite athleticism. Development of offensive skills will raise his ceiling immensely. Great rebounder on both ends. Very good rim protector. Struggles guarding players on the perimeter commits fouls at a high rate on defense.
#25 Malik Hall	F	Jr.	6-7	225	9/28	17.5	5.0	4.2	1.3	48.9%	36.4%	69.5%	Played in every game in both of his seasons, and started 9 games each season. Was expected to take a big step forward after a promising freshman season, but mostly stayed where he was at. A versatile player who helps the team in many areas. Can score fromm the block with a variety of post moves, and can stretch out the defense by hitting 3P shots. Is a strong and physical player who plays good defense on the block. Struggles to protect the rim because of his height.
#30 Marcus Bingham Jr.	F	Sr.	6-11	225	5/28	11.5	3.5	3.2	0.3	50.0%	0.0%	73.8%	Had similar stats to his sophomore season, but developed a lot during his junior year. Played his best basketball towards the end of the regular season. His biggest impact is as a rim protector on defense (7-4 wingspan). Played good post defense against some of the best block scorers in the conference. Struggles with mobility and strength at times. Is a good finisher around the rim when set up by others, and showed small flashes of offensive postgame development last season.
#34 Julius Marble	F	Jr.	6-8	225	9/27	9.3	4.0	2.1	0.1	57.7%	100.0%	68.4%	Started 9 games last season after playing off the bench his whole freshman year. Skilled offensive player who can score in many different ways. Moves well without the ball. Struggles on defense. Often doesn't know where to be. Not a great rebounder; he doesn't show consistent effort on the boards or attack them with enough physicality. Averages 10.2 fouls per 40 minutes, and obviously won't be able to play extended minutes if he can't improve that.
#44 Gabe Brown	F	Sr.	6-8	210	5/25	20.7	7.2	2.7	0.5	47.1%	42.0%	88.2%	Has averaged over 20 MPG his last two seasons and has scored around 7 PPG. Forced to miss some time last year after testing positive for COVID. Improved on all of his shooting numbers last year, especially from 3 where he hit 42% of his shots. Needs others to set him up offensively. Hasn't shown good playmaking abilities. With his size and athleticism, he should be a much better rebounder than he is.
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)					95.8 (48%)	31.7 (46%)	20.9 (56%)	5.4 (34%)					

New Players

Player Information					Notes
Position	Year	Height	Weight	Last School	
Jaden Akins	Fr.	6-3	160	Ypsi Prep Academy (MI)	4-star recruit; 50th ranked player in the 2021 class. Super quick score-first point guard. Good size and length for his position. Will need to add weight. Capable shooter, but at his best getting to the rim. Has good defensive potential with his quick feet and length, but makes some mental mistakes on that end of the floor.
Pierre Brooks	Fr.	6-6	205	Douglass Academy (MI)	4-star recruit; 57th ranked player in the 2021 class. Michigan HS basketball Player of the Year. Strong 2-guard who is a naturally gifted scorer, especially going towards the rim. Can shoot the ball from well past the 3P line. Averaged over 33 PPG on the way to winning the State Championship his senior year of high school.
Max Christie	Fr.	6-6	195	Rolling Meadows HS (IL)	5-star recruit; 16th ranked player in the 2021 class. McDonald's All American. Good size and length, but needs to get stronger. High IQ player. Is best as a shooter who can shoot over the top of defenders because of his height and length. Because of his size, has high potential in every aspect of the game.
Tyson Walker	Jr.	6-0	170	Northeastern	Started 48 of his 50 games at Northwestern. Was the CAA Defensive Player of the Year last year, but played just as big of a role of the offensive end. Averaged almost 19 PPG and 5 APG on 35% 3P shooting his sophomore year, along with 2.4 steals/game.

2021-22 Season Preview

- Rankings in "Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25": #13 (Yahoo!), #18 (CBS), #23 (ESPN).
- The Spartans lost 6 players this offseason. They lost their top 3 players in minutes played, 3 of their top 4 scorers, and 4 of their top 5 assist leaders. F Aaron Henry (NBA Draft), G Joshua Langford (graduate), G Rocket Watts (transfer), and G Foster Loyer (transfer) all played more than 15 MPG for them last year.
- The Spartans return 48% of their minutes played but only 46% of points scored from last season.
- Michigan State currently has the 9th ranked recruiting class for 2021 made up of 5-star guard Max Christie, 4-star guard Jaden Akins, and 4-star guard/forward Pierre Brooks.
- The Spartans are also adding transfer Tyson Walker, who will immediately fill a need they have in their roster (point guard) as well as provide a great defensive presence.
- Michigan State lost a lot of talent and production this offseason but bring in a lot as well. They have a lot of options at the forward position, but nobody who has proved that they can be consistently relied on. If one or two of their big guys take a big step forward this season, and the highly touted freshman are able to contribute immediately, this squad will easily be a second tier Big Ten team and look to compete in the postseason.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Tyson Walker Junior	Max Christie Freshman	Gabe Brown Senior	Joey Hauser RS - Junior	Marcus Bingham Jr. Senior
Jaden Akins Freshman	A.J. Hoggard Sophomore	Pierre Brooks Freshman	Malik Hall Junior	Julius Marble II Junior
				Mady Sissoko Sophomore

The Spartans currently have at 11 scholarship players and have room to add 2 more guys to the roster.



Minnesota Golden Gophers

Head Coach: Ben Johnson
(1st Season)

Williams Arena
Minneapolis, Minnesota



Key Returning Players

Isaiah Ihnen	6'9"	F	2.8 PPG	14.3 MPG
---------------------	-------------	----------	----------------	-----------------

Key Players Lost

Marcus Carr	6'2"	G	19.4 PPG	35.8 MPG
Liam Robbins	7'0"	C	11.7 PPG	24.7 MPG
Gabe Kalscheur	6'4"	G	9.2 PPG	30.7 MPG

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 14-15 (6-14 B1G) for a 13th place finish in the B1G. Started the season 10-2 with wins over Iowa, Michigan State, and Ohio State. Finished the season by losing 8 of their last 9 games. No NCAAT appearance for the 5th time in the last 7 years.
- Finished 81st in NET ranking, 62nd in KenPom, and unranked in the final AP Poll or Coaches Poll.
- 4-11 Record in Quadrant I games. 0-10 record on the road (1-1 neutral).
- G Marcus Carr was named AP All-Big Ten First Team this season after finishing third in the conference in scoring and assist and finishing first in minutes played. He set career highs for himself in points, steals, free throw and 3P attempts, and free throw and 3P makes.
- Scored 72.5 PPG, 139th most in the nation. Finished 76th in adj. offensive efficiency (10th B1G).
- Played exclusively man defense. Gave up 73.2 PPG, 257th fewest in the nation. Finished 56th in adj. defensive efficiency (14th B1G).
- Pace of 69.9 rated 88th in the NCAA and 5th in the Big Ten.
- Had an effective field goal percentage of 45.0%, 329th best in the nation. Had a team 3P% of 28.4%, 339th best in the nation. Didn't have a single player shoot better than 33% from 3.
- Took care of the ball, only turning it over on 15.6% of possessions, 20th best in the nation.
- Score 23.2% of their points from the free throw line, 7th most in the nation.
- Only allowed opponents to shoot 31.7% of their shots from 3, 25th lowest rate in the nation.

Offseason Timeline

- March 11** – Lost to Ohio State in the second round of the Big Ten Tournament to end their 2020-21 season.
- March 15** – HC Richard Pitino is fired.
- March 16** – F Jarvis Omersa enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to St. Thomas.
- March 17** – G Jamal Mashburn Jr. enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to New Mexico.
- March 19** – G Marcus Carr enters the transfer portal.
- March 22** – Ben Johnson is announced as the next Head Coach.
- March 26** – G Tre' Williams enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Oregon State.
- March 29** – Former George Washington F Jamison Battle commits to transfer to Minnesota.
- March 30** – F Martice Mitchell enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Northern Illinois. G Marcus Carr enters the NBA Draft. He doesn't sign an agent then, but eventually does.
- April 1** – G Gabe Kalscheur enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Iowa State.
- April 2** – Former William & Mary G Luke Loewe commits to transfer to Minnesota. Former Lafayette G Elyjah Stephens commits to transfer to Minnesota.
- April 6** – C Liam Roberts enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Vanderbilt.
- April 9** – Dave Thorson (previously at Colorado State) and Jason Kemp (previously at William & Mary) are announced as Assistant Coaches.
- April 11** – Former New Hampshire G Sean Sutherlin commits to transfer to Minnesota.
- April 15** – Former Northern State F Parker Fox commits to transfer to Minnesota.
- April 16** – Former Charleston G Payton Willis commits to transfer to Minnesota.
- April 30** – Marcus Jenkins (previously at Richmond) is announced as an Assistant Coach.
- May 2** – F Brandon Johnson enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to DePaul.
- May 4** – C Sam Freeman enters the transfer portal.
- May 11** – G Both Gach enters the transfer portal.

Returning Players

Player Information				2020-21 Season Stats							Notes		
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%		FT%	
#35 Isaiah Ihnen	F	Jr.	6-9	220	3/29	14.3	2.8	3.5	0.6	31.8%	22.0%	78.9%	Played a reserve role, but started 3 games last season. Had a terrible year from 3, only shooting 22%. Has taken 71% of his shots from 3 during his 2 year career.
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)					14.3 (7%)	2.8 (4%)	3.5 (10%)	0.6 (4%)					

New Players

Player Information		2020-21 Season Stats							Notes
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	
#0 Payton Willis	G	RS Super Sr.	6-4	200	Charleston				Played two seasons at Vanderbilt where he contributed 5.2 PPG in 18 MPG. Sat out a redshirt year due to transfer rules, then played a year at Minnesota where he scored 8.6 PPG in almost 30 MPG. Then transferred to Charleston and put up 13.4 PPG in 34 MPG. Now returning to Minnesota to finish his career. Career 36% 3P shooter. Not known for doing much on the floor besides scoring.
#10 Jamison Battle	F	Jr.	6-7	225	George Washington				Played over 35 MPG both of his years at GWU. Scored 11.8 and 17.3 PPG his two years there. Was the main scorer on a bad team his sophomore year, but scored with decent efficiency. 36% career 3P shooter, and 56% from 2P range for his career. Will likely be on of the top scoring options on the team this year.
#12 Luke Loewe	G	Super Sr.	6-4	186	Williams & Mary				After not playing much his freshman year, and not scoring much his sophomore year, he did a lot of both his last two seasons at Williams & Mary. Has shot under 30% from 3P range in 3 of his 4 years, but his career percentage is raised to 35% because of his junior year when he hit 44% of his 3PA. Coming off of a career high in assist (3.2/game). Known as a high effort defender.
#20 Eylljah Stephens	G	Super Sr.	6-3	176	Lafayette				Increased his scoring average and minutes played all 4 years of his career. Averaged 16.4 PPG last year as a senior. Only shoots 33% from 3P range for his career, but is a terrific FT shooter, making 90.4% of his attempts last year.
#24 Sean Sutherlin	G	Super Sr.	6-5	200	New Hampshire				Played at Sheridan College for his first two college seasons. High intensity guard who has been an elite rebounder. Led the conference in defensive rebounding his junior year, and was second in overall rebounding. Poor 3P shooter and FT shooter who turns the ball over at a very high rate. Missed all of last season recovering from a hip injury.
#23 Parker Fox	F	RS Sr.	6-8	210	Northern State				Expected to be the best player brought in this offseason. Had many high major offers. Was a Division II First Team All-American last season. He averaged 22.3 PPG and 9.9 RPG while shooting 65% from the field. Limited to scoring around the rim. Led the conference in blocked shots and won Defensive Player of the Year.
#42 Treyton Thompson	C	Fr.	6-11	190	La Lumiere School (IN)				3-star recruit; 133rd ranked player in the 2021 class. Has shown potential to space the floor with a jumpshot. Not much of a high scorer in high school or AAU ball. Plays a high IQ game, and passes well out of the post. Has the height for a Big Ten center, but needs to add a lot of muscle mass.

2021-22 Season Preview

- Unranked in all current “Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25” by CBS, Yahoo!, and ESPN.
- The Golden Gophers lost 12 players this offseason. Through graduation, the transfer portal, and the NBA Draft, all but 1 player (Isaiah Ihnen) departed from the Golden Gophers program this offseason.
- The Golden Gophers return only 7% of their minutes played and 4% of points scored from last season.
- Minnesota currently has the 89th ranked recruiting class for 2021. They only have 1 commit: C Treyton Thompson.
- The Golden Gophers have been filling out their roster with transfers. As of now, they have had 6 commit to joining the program.
- Minnesota has had a theme in what they have added to the roster this offseason. Most of their guys are from the state of Minnesota, so they are evidently looking for local talent.
- This roster still only has 8 players, so it has a long way to go before the season begins. Coach Johnson and his staff have brought in a bunch of guys who have performed very well at low majors and even DII schools, but it will be interesting to see how that translates to the Big Ten. Some of them will probably work out while some won't. The Golden Gophers will need to keep adding to this roster, but I don't see them making any additions to keep them out of the very bottom of the Big Ten this season.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Luke Loewe Super Senior	Payton Willis RS - Super Senior	Sean Sutherlin Super Senior	Jamison Battle Junior	Parker Fox RS - Senior
	Eyljah Stephens Super Senior		Isaiah Ihnen Junior	Treyton Thompson Freshman

The Golden Gophers currently sit at 8 scholarship players and will be adding more as the offseason progresses.



Nebraska Cornhuskers

Head Coach: Fred Hoiberg
(3rd Season, 14-45)

Pinnacle Bank Arena
Lincoln, Nebraska



Key Returning Players

Trey McGowens	6'4"	G	10.7 PPG	28.4 MPG
Dalano Banton	6'9"	G	9.6 PPG	27.3 MPG
Lat Mayen	6'9"	F	8.6 PPG	25.6 MPG

Key Players Lost

Teddy Allen	6'6"	G	16.5 PPG	27.2 MPG
Thorir Thorbjarnarson	6'6"	G	3.9 PPG	22.1 MPG

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 7-20 (3-16 B1G) for a 14th place finish in the B1G (11th or worse in the B1G in 6 of the past 7 seasons). No NCAA appearance for the 6th consecutive season.
- Finished 129th in NET ranking, 109th in KenPom, and unranked in the final AP Poll or Coaches Poll.
- 1-12 Record in Quadrant I games. 1-6 Record in Quadrant II games.
- G Teddy Allen was an honorable mention All-Big Ten selection. He led the Cornhuskers in scoring, and had eight 20-point performances, including a 41-point game against Penn State.
- Scored 70.0 PPG, 207th most in the nation. Finished 179th in adj. offensive efficiency (14th B1G).
- Played man defense 82% of possessions. Gave up 72.4 PPG, 274th fewest in the nation. Finished 40th in adj. defensive efficiency (11th B1G).
- Pace of 71.8 rated 35th in the NCAA and 1st in the Big Ten.
- Average offensive possession length of 15.5 seconds, 15th fastest in the NCAA.
- Don't get many offensive rebounds (299th highest rate nationally) and are not a good free throw shooting team (63.9% as a team; 330th).
- They allow opponents to shoot 45% of their shots from 3 (25th highest rate) but only allow opponents to shoot 31.3% on those shots.

Offseason Timeline

- March 1** – G Teddy Allen leaves the program, and eventually commits to transfer to New Mexico.
- March 10** – Lost to Penn State in the first round of the Big Ten Tournament to end their 2020-21 season.
- March 15** – G Elijah Wood enters the transfer portal. F Yvan Ouedraogo enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Grand Canyon. F Akol Arop enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Nebraska – Omaha.
- March 16** – G Kobe Webster announces that he will return to Nebraska to use his extra year of eligibility.
- March 26** – Former Xavier G CJ Wilcher commits to transfer to Nebraska.
- April 5** – 2021 3-star C Oleg Kojenets commits to Nebraska.
- April 6** – Nate Loenser (previously with the Chicago Bulls) is announced as an Assistant Coach. Doc Sadler is moved to a different role.
- April 17** – Former DePaul G Keon Edwards commits to transfer to Nebraska.
- April 21** – G Shamiel Stevenson declares for the NBA Draft with the intent of hiring an agent.
- April 23** – G Thorir Thorbjarnarson announces that he will not return for his extra year of eligibility and will pursue a professional basketball career.
- May 3** – 2021 3-star G Quaran McPherson commits to Nebraska.

Returning Players

Player Information				2020-21 Season Stats								Notes	
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%		
#2 Trey McGowens	G	Sr.	6-4	191	27/27	28.4	10.7	3.9	2.3	39.1%	36.7%	65.7%	Played at Pitt for his first two seasons. Started 64 out of 66 games and averaged 28.4 MPG his two years there. Started all 27 games for Nebraska last year. Raised his 3P% from 32% his first two years to 37% last year. Averages 1.8 steals/game over his 3 seasons. Was playing his best basketball at the end of the season, and scored in double figures 6 out of the last 7 games. Expected to be a major contributor this year.
#10 Kobe Webster	G	Super Sr.	6-0	172	5/27	23.1	5.9	1.7	1.3	38.2%	38.0%	65.4%	Played for 3 seasons at Western Illinois where he started 85 of the 85 games he played in and averaged 16.7 PPG. Started just the final 5 games last year for Nebraska and scored 8 PPG. Improved on his 3P shooting (38% last year; best on the team).
#11 Lat Mayen	F	RS Sr.	6-9	205	27/27	25.6	8.6	4.5	0.6	39.6%	34.8%	77.8%	Redshirted his freshman year at TCU, then played a limited role there in 17 games his second year before his season ended early due to a knee injury. He played the next year at Chipola Junior College where he averaged 11.8 points and 8.4 rebounds per game on 47% shooting and 38% from 3P range. Started all 27 games for Nebraska last season where his numbers almost all dropped, but were still important to the team. Finished the season playing the best basketball of his career.
#13 Derrick Walker	F	RS Sr.	6-8	232	16/16	20.7	5.9	4.8	1.6	60.0%	0.0%	45.5%	Played a very limited role at Tennessee his freshman and sophomore seasons. Had to sit a year before playing last year for Nebraska. Was suspended the first half of the season, but started every game from that point forward. Very limited to scoring around the rim, but finishes there at a high rate. Good defender with good versatility.
#14 Trevor Lakes	F	Super Sr.	6-7	215	1/14	9.6	3.2	1.1	0.4	37.5%	33.3%	75.0%	Spent three seasons at Indianapolis. Scored 16 PPG with 40% 3P shooting his junior year. Only played a limited role last season at Nebraska. He mostly came off the bench to be a 3P shooter, where he only converted at a 33% rate (90% of his shots came from 3). If he doesn't improve his shooting, or add more diversity to his game, he could get buried on the bench this season.
#35 Eduardo Andre	C	So.	6-10	228	0/20	8.8	2.7	2.2	0.5	64.7%	N/A	45.0%	Former 3-star recruit; 226th ranked player in the 2020 class. Long athlete, but still very raw. Very limited in his offensive game to finishing dump-offs around the rim. Will have a bigger impact on defense, where he has lots of potential. However, he struggled to stay on the floor very long this year, partially because of his absurdly high foul rate.
#45 Dalano Banton	G	RS Jr.	6-9	204	22/27	27.3	9.6	5.9	3.9	41.1%	24.7%	65.9%	Played a limited role for Western Kentucky his freshman year. Sat out a year before playing for Nebraska last season. Played an important role for them as he played 27 MPG and put up just under 10 PPG. Only shot 24.7% from the 3P line last year (an improvement from his time at WKU) and still shot 3 3P per game. Good rebounder for his position, and solid playmaker for others.
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)					128.8 (64%)	44.2 (63%)	21.1 (58%)	9.6 (70%)					

New Players

Position		Year	Height	Weight	Last School	Notes
Wilhelm Breidenbach	F	Fr.	6-9	210	Mater Dei HS (CA)	4-star recruit; 99th ranked player in the 2021 class. Long and very mobile player, but needs to improve strength. High energy player who can play inside the paint or outside the 3P line. Runs the floor really well. Known for an elite left hand hook shot in HS.
Keon Edwards	G	So.	6-7	185	DePaul	Former 4-star recruit; 93rd ranked player in the 2020 class. Played a limited role in just 5 games for DePaul last year. An athletic wing who can score at all three levels. Good at creating his own shot, but also good at moving without the ball to get open. Has the size and athleticism to be a versatile defender, but hasn't necessarily shown good defensive traits to this point in his career.
Oleg Kojenets	G	Fr.	7-0	220	Western Reserve Academy (OH)	3-star recruit; 196th ranked player in the 2021 class. Long player (7-1 wingspan). Will need time to develop, but has the size, and has shown good skills for his size, including finishing, driving, and passing. However, he likely won't play a big role this year.
Bryce McGowens	G	Fr.	6-6	170	Legacy Charter (SC)	5-star recruit; 25th ranked player in the 2021 class. Great positional size and length for a 2-guard. Great athlete who can do some of everything. Is a great shooter, especially off of the dribble. Needs to add weight, but should make an immediate scoring impact at the Big Ten level.
Quaran McPherson	G	Fr.	6-3	180	Link Year Prep (MO)	3-star recruit; 208th ranked player in the 2021 class. Physical guard who is known for his willingness to compete.
Keisel Tominaga	G	Jr.	6-2	176	Ranger Junior College (TX)	3-star recruit; 10th ranked JUCO player in the 2021 class. Needs to get stronger, but is an elite shooter from 3P range. If he can limit his weaknesses and be ready to play at the Big Ten level, his role will be to come off the bench and shoot some 3s.
CJ Wilcher	G	So.	6-5	195	Xavier	Former 4-star recruit; 113th ranked player in the 2020 class. Played a limited role for Xavier his freshman year. A strong wing player, but not very mobile or athletic for his position. Great shooter with a quick release. Knows how to move well without the ball. Struggles on defense because of his mobility.

2021-22 Season Preview

- Unranked in all current “Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25” by CBS, Yahoo!, and ESPN.
- The Cornhuskers lost 6 players this offseason, but only a couple of them made much of an impact on last years team. G Teddy Allen (transfer – New Mexico) left the team before last season was even over. Thorir Thorbjarnarson decided not to use his extra year of eligibility to return to the Huskers and is instead pursuing a pro career.
- The Cornhuskers return 64% of their minutes played and 63% of points scored from last season. Nebraska currently has the 16th ranked recruiting class for 2021, one of their highest rated classes in program history. The class is made up of 5 players, with two of them coming in as top 100 recruits. 5-star guard Bryce McGowens and 4-star forward Wilhelm Breidenbach with both look to make immediate impacts.
- The Huskers are also adding 2 transfers who were highly rated 2020 recruits: G CJ Wilcher and F Keon Edwards.
- After coming last in the Big Ten last year, then losing your top scorer, many would think that Nebraska was doomed to repeat its finish in last place. However, the Huskers didn’t lose near as much talent as they brought in, and they have a handful of talented players returning. This could be a team that makes an NCAAT appearance if things go right for them.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Trey McGowens Senior	Kobe Webster Super Senior	Bryce McGowens Freshman	Lat Mayen RS - Senior	Derrick Walker RS - Senior
Dalano Banton RS - Junior	CJ Wilcher Sophomore	Keon Edwards Sophomore	Wilhelm Breidenbach Freshman	Eduardo Andre Sophomore
	Keisei Tominaga Junior		Trevor Lakes RS - Sophomore	Oleg Kojenets Freshman
	Quaran McPherson Freshman			

The Cornhuskers currently sit at 14 scholarship players, but Webster and Lakes don’t count against the limit, so if they want to, they could add one more player to this roster.



Northwestern Wildcats

Head Coach: Chris Collins
(9th Season, 118-134)

Welsh-Ryan Arena
Evanston, Illinois



Key Returning Players

Chase Audige	6'4"	G	12.3 PPG	28.2 MPG
Pete Nance	6'10"	F	10.3 PPG	27.7 MPG
Boo Buie	6'2"	G	10.3 PPG	26.9 MPG

Key Players Lost

Miller Kopp	6'7"	F	11.3 PPG	31.5 MPG
Anthony Gaines	6'4"	G	3.9 PPG	20.8 MPG

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 9-15 (6-13 B1G) for a 12th place finish in the B1G (finished 10th or worse 6 of the last 8 years). No NCAAT appearance for the 3rd consecutive season.
- Started conference play 3-0 and were ranked as high as #19 in the nation by the AP Poll. They then went on a 13-game losing streak that lasted from late December to late February.
- Finished 96th in NET ranking, 79th in KenPom, and unranked in the final AP Poll or Coaches Poll.
- 2-11 Record in Quadrant I games.
- Northwestern was the only team in the Big Ten to have four different players average double figures in scoring for the season. G Chase Audige led the team in points scored and steals and was second in minutes played. G Boo Buie led the team in assist and 3P made, all while averaging 10.3 PPG, good for 4th on the team.
- Scored 70.3 PPG, 203rd most in the nation. Finished 132nd in adj. offensive efficiency (12th B1G).
- Played man defense 88% of possessions. Gave up 70.0 PPG, 174th fewest in the nation. Finished 37th in adj. defensive efficiency (13th B1G).
- Pace of 68.4 rated 160th in the NCAA and 6th in the Big Ten.
- Had an offensive rebound rate of 19.9, 23rd worst in the nation.
- Allowed opponents to record an assist on 60.3% of their made FGs, 29th worst in the nation.

Offseason Timeline

- **March 10** – Lost to Minnesota in the first round of Big Ten Tournament to end their 2020-21 season.
- **March 24** – F Miller Kopp enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Indiana.
- **April 5** – Assistant Coach Emanuel Dildy announces that he will be leaving Northwestern to take a job at Oklahoma. G Anthony Gaines enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Siena
- **April 12** – Former Fairleigh Dickinson F Elyjah Williams commits to transfer to Northwestern.
- **May 11** – Talor Battle (previously at Penn State) is announced as an Assistant Coach.

Returning Players

Player Information				2020-21 Season Stats								Notes	
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%		
#0 Boo Buie	G	Jr.	6-2	180	19/24	26.9	10.3	2.3	4.0	36.9%	36.0%	78.2%	Played similar minutes and had similar scoring numbers in his first two years, but bumped his assist from 2.4 to 4.0 per game while improving his 3P shooting from 28 to 36% in his sophomore year. Started last season playing very well, averaging 14.4 PPG through 7 games, including a 30 pt game vs Mich St. He also finished the season strong, scoring 17.5 PPG in the last 4 games. However, he struggled in the middle, including a 3 games stretch where he scored just 2
#1 Chase Audige	G	RS Jr.	6-4	200	23/24	28.2	12.3	3.7	1.8	40.4%	33.9%	54.4%	A long, athletic player who can do a little bit of everything and provide a positive impact on both ends of the floor. Played his freshman season at William & Mary before transferring to Northwestern. Scored 12.3 PPG and was the team's leading scorer last year, but was much less efficient than he was his freshman year. Is very good at creating his own shot when needed. Acted as the team's go-to guy down the stretch of close games. Struggled with TOs, FT shooting, and fouls.
#2 Ryan Greer	G	Sr.	6-2	190	1/23	13.0	2.7	1.4	1.5	50.0%	47.1%	87.5%	Redclassified to come to NW early after a class of 2018 recruit was refused admission to the school. Averaged 10 MPG in his 3 seasons and has only started 1 game. Has greatly improved on his 3P shooting each season, going from 24% his freshman year to 47% last year from behind the arc. Reliable passer and ball handler with a 2.6:1 AST/TO ratio last year. Struggles to guard good athletes.
#3 Ty Berry	G	So.	6-3	190	0/22	14.5	5.1	1.5	0.9	40.2%	36.5%	60.0%	Former 3-star recruit; 153rd ranked player in the 2020 class. His role was to be a shooter and provide spacing for the second unit. Shot 69% of his FGA from behind the arc, which was the highest rate on the team. Scrappy defender who showed consistent effort on both ends. Had the highest steal rate on the team. Needs to work on other parts of his game to become less one-dimensional in order to expand his role this season.
#15 Ryan Young	C	RS Jr.	6-10	245	5/24	18.9	7.8	4.8	1.4	57.4%	50.0%	73.8%	Redshirted his freshman year, started every game his second year, then started just 5 games and played reduced minutes last year. Can't space the floor with shooting, but finishes at the rim at a high rate. Top 15 in the conference in both offensive and defensive rebound rate. Strong 1v1 offensive post game. Led the team in PER. Struggles with TOs, especially when being doubled in the post. Not very mobile, so he can be a liability on defense.
#22 Pete Nance	F	Sr.	6-10	225	24/24	27.7	11.1	6.8	1.8	49.5%	36.4%	78.4%	Doubled his minutes from his freshman to sophomore year while nearly tripling his scoring. Last year he played about the same amount of minutes as the year before, but added 2.5 PPG more to his scoring average. Has improved his shooting percentages every year so far, and became a reliable 3P shooter last year after shooting under 30% each of his first two years from beyond the arc.
#31 Robbie Beran	F	Jr.	6-9	215	18/24	20.2	5.7	2.7	1.1	44.4%	35.1%	66.7%	Started 18 games each of his first two seasons. Increased his 2P% by about 16 percent last year, but was used in more of a 3P shooting role, where his efficiency dropped slightly. Not able to create his own shot, limiting his offensive upside. Very good defender, but does find himself in foul trouble often.
#34 Matthew Nicholson	C	So.	7-0	255	0/9	2.6	1.0	0.7	0.1	44.4%	N/A	25.0%	Only played 23 minutes his freshman year. Has the size, but needs to develop his skills to have a chance at contributing to the team this year.
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)					149.4 (74%)	55.1 (78%)	26.2 (78%)	12.4 (84%)					

New Players

Player Information					2020-21 Season Stats							Notes	
	Position	Year	Height	Weight	Last School								
Brooks Barnhizer	F	Fr.	6-6	200	Jefferson HS (IN)	3-star recruit; 153rd ranked player in the 2021 class. Played his senior season of high school with a stress fracture in his left foot. Scored 34 PPG his senior year, and his mostly known for his offensive game.							
Julian Roper	G	Fr.	6-3	183	St. Mary's HS (MI)	3-star recruit; 151st ranked player in the 2021 class. Outstanding athlete. At his best in transition and as a slasher. Was an elite high school perimeter defender who is projected to carry that skill to the next level.							
Casey Simmons	G	Fr.	6-5	170	Milton Academy (MA)	4-star recruit; 98th ranked player in the 2021 class. Second highest ranked recruit in program history. Expected to make an impact from day 1.							
Elyjah Williams	F	Super Sr.	6-7	220	Fairleigh Dickinson	Averaged 14 points and 8 rebounds per game while shooting 56% from the floor and 42% from 3 his senior year. Struggled with turnovers, averaging over 3/game. His skills and size naturally compare to Miller Kopp, who transferred from the program this offseason. He will try to replace the production that Kopp provided.							

2021-22 Season Preview

- Unranked in all current “Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25” by CBS, Yahoo!, and ESPN.
- The Wildcats lost 3 players this offseason. Only 2 of them were in the rotation: F Miller Kopp (transfer – Indiana) and G Anthony Gaines (transfer – Siena).
- The Wildcats return 74% of their minutes played and 78% of points scored from last season.
- Northwestern currently has the 34th ranked recruiting class for 2021 made up of 4-star guard Casey Simmons, 3-star guard Julian Roper, and 3-star forward Brooks Barnhizer.
- The Wildcats are also adding transfer F Elyjah Williams who was brought in to try and replace what Miller Kopp brought to this team.
- Northwestern had a rough season last year, but they showed some flashes against good teams, and lost a handful of very close games. Miller Kopp was one of their best players, but overall, they didn’t lose much talent this offseason, and are bringing in one of the best recruiting classes in their program history. They will probably finish in the bottom half of the Big Ten again, but if everything goes right for them, they could be a sneaky team that has a chance at an NCAAT appearance.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Boo Buie Junior	Chase Audige RS - Junior	Elyjah Williams Super Senior	Pete Nance Senior	Ryan Young RS - Junior
Ty Berry Sophomore	Casey Simmons Freshman	Brooks Barnhizer Freshman	Robbie Beran Junior	Matthew Nicholson Sophomore
Ryan Greer Senior	Julian Roper Freshman			

The Wildcats have 12 scholarship players and can add one more to the roster if they want to.



Ohio State Buckeyes

Head Coach: Chris Holtmann
(5th Season, 87-44)

Value City Arena
Columbus, Ohio



Key Returning Players

Duane Washington Jr*	6'3"	G	16.4 PPG	32.2 MPG
E.J. Liddell*	6'7"	F	16.2 PPG	29.4 MPG
Justice Sueing	6'7"	F	10.7 PPG	28.3 MPG

Key Players Lost

CJ Walker	6'1"	G	9.5 PPG	30.0 MPG
-----------	------	---	---------	----------

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 21-10 (12-8 B1G) for a 5th place finish in the B1G (top 5 finish 3 of last 4 years). Third consecutive NCAAT appearance. Earned a 2 seed, lost to Oral Roberts in the Round of 64.
- Finished 13th in NET ranking, 11th in KenPom, 7th in the final AP Poll, and 15th in the final Coaches Poll.
- 9-6 Record in Quadrant I games.
- E.J. Liddell was named First Team All-Big Ten by the AP and by the Big Ten coaches. He led the team in rebounds, blocks, FTA, and FT made. He was also second on the team in scoring and third on the team in minutes played.
- Duane Washington Jr. was named Third Team All-Big Ten and Big Ten Co-Player of the Week this year after leading the Buckeyes in scoring. He had ten games with 20 or more points and two 30-point performances this season. He made at least one 3-pointer in all 31 games of the season.
- Scored 77.2 PPG, 46th most in the nation. Finished 4th in adj. offensive efficiency (2nd B1G).
- Played man defense 99% of possessions. Gave up 71.1 PPG, 201st fewest in the nation. Finished 82nd in adj. defensive efficiency (10th B1G).
- Pace of 66.7 rated 251st in the NCAA and 7th in the Big Ten.
- Only turned the ball over on 15.5% of possessions (18th best nationally). Got to the FT line at the 40th best rate in the nation.
- Only forced turnovers on 14.7% of defensive possessions (21st worst nationally).

Offseason Timeline

- **March 19** – Lost to Oral Roberts 75-72 in OT in the Round of 64.
- **March 30** – Former Penn State G Jamari Wheeler commits to transfer to Ohio State.
- **March 31** – F E.J. Liddell declares for the NBA Draft but will still remain eligible to possibly return to Ohio State. G Musa Jallow enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Charlotte.
- **April 9** - G Duane Washington Jr. declares for the NBA Draft but will still remain eligible to possibly return to Ohio State.
- **April 12** – G CJ Walker declares for the NBA Draft and signs an agent.
- **April 16** - F Kyle Young announces that he will return to Ohio State to use his extra year of eligibility.
- **April 17** – Former Indiana C Joey Brunk commits to transfer to Ohio State.
- **April 22** – Assistant Coach Terry Johnson announces he will be leaving Ohio State to take a job at Purdue.
- **May 3** – C Ibrahima Diallo enters the transfer portal.

Returning Players

Player Information				2020-21 Season Stats								Notes	
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%		
#0 Meechie Johnson Jr.	G	So.	6-2	172	0/17	5.8	1.2	0.4	0.2	38.9%	50.0%	16.7%	Former 4-star recruit; 126th ranked player in the 2020 class. Considered a "scoring machine" coming out of high school. Enrolled in Ohio State in December 2020. Played in 17 of the last 19 games of the season. Point guard who is expected to take a bigger role this season after the departure of CJ Walker and a little more time to learn the program.
#1 Jimmy Sotos	G	Super Sr.	6-3	200	2/12	9.6	1.7	0.8	1.1	33.3%	33.3%	75.0%	Played 3 seasons at Bucknell before transferring to Ohio State. Played in 12 games last season before suffering a season ending shoulder injury. Attempted 83% of his shots from 3P range last season while shooting 33% from there. Point guard whose strength is creating for others. Will likely have a limited role this season behind Wheeler and Johnson Jr.
#3 Eugene Brown III	G	So.	6-6	195	0/29	6.2	1.2	1.3	0.2	35.1%	28.0%	50.0%	Former 3-star recruit; 143rd ranked player in the 2020 class. A good, strong athlete with great length who shoots well off the bounce and off the catch. He did struggle scoring efficiently last year, especially from 3 (28%). A good rebounder who is a capable defender. He has a lot of competition for minutes next season but could carve out a role for himself, depending on how much he improves this offseason.
#4 Duane Washington Jr.	G	Sr.	6-3	210	31/31	32.2	16.4	3.4	2.9	41.0%	37.4%	83.5%	Has been an impact player since his freshman year. Scored 7.0 PPG as a freshman, 11.5 as a sophomore, and 16.4 as a junior. Has also improved his FG% every year, while raising his 3PA rate every year while (57% last year). Also raised his APG to 2.9 last season after only recording 1.4 per game his sophomore year. He is currently testing the NBA Draft waters, but will likley return to attempt to boost his stock for the 2022 Draft.
#10 Justin Ahrens	F	Sr.	6-6	195	18/31	18.3	5.7	1.9	0.4	43.3%	42.5%	70.0%	Has averaged 4.0 PPG during his career. Last year was the first season he was a true rotation player, and was put in the starting lineup for 18 games after an injury to CJ Walker. Last season, he shot 7 2P, 10 FT, and 127 3P shots. Played well most of the season, but over the last 9 games, he scored 2.1 PPG while shooting 23% from 3. He is a career 41% 3P shooter.
#14 Justice Sueing	F	RS Sr.	6-7	215	31/31	28.3	10.7	5.5	1.5	49.1%	36.1%	75.0%	Started 61 games in 2 years at California. Averaged 14.1 PPG. Sat out a year due to transfer rules, then started all 31 games for the Buckeyes last season. He's an athletic wing who rebounds and defends. He doesn't create his own shots or create shots for others. Scoring numbers went down at OSU, but shooting percentages went from 43/31/73 to 49/36/75.
#23 Zed Key	F	So.	6-8	245	1/31	11.7	5.2	3.4	0.3	61.6%	N/A	55.1%	Former 3-star recruit; 155th ranked player in the 2020 class. Played in all 31 games his freshman year (started 1). Played backup center behind Liddell. Looked good against some of the best centers/players in the Big Ten. Will have a role for this team regardless, but could be one of the more important players for the Buckeyes if Luddell decides not to return to OSU.
#25 Kyle Young	F	Super Sr.	6-8	225	26/27	26.3	8.6	5.5	1.3	54.3%	43.3%	84.6%	Has played 20+ MPG his last 3 seasons. Shot under 20% from 3P range his first 3 years, but shot 43% last year. Physical player and good rebounder and defender. Will be a leader for this team. Might see a minutes reduction with the emergence of Zed Key.
#31 Seth Towns	F	RS Sr.	6-8	230	0/25	10.8	3.8	2.2	0.3	42.1%	34.1%	80.0%	Was a standout at Harvard his first two seasons, scoring 14.2 PPG while shooting 42/42/81. Sat out two consecutive years due to injury issues, then transferred to Ohio State. He only played about 10 MPG last year, but was able to make an impact during that time. I would expect a similar bench role for him this year, especially with all the options the Buckeyes have.
#32 E.J. Liddell	F	Jr.	6-7	240	29/29	29.4	16.2	6.7	1.8	47.4%	33.8%	74.6%	One of the best players in the Big Ten last year, and will be again if he takes his name out of the NBA Draft. Improved his scoring by nearly 10 PPG between his freshman and sophomore seasons. Improved his 3P shooting from 19% to 34% as well. Good rebounder. Had to defend some of the best centers in the Big Ten, but now with Joey Brunk in the mix, that should take a little off of his plate defensively.
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)				162.7 (80%)	66.3 (86%)	31.9 (87%)	8.7 (67%)						

New Players

	Position	Year	Height	Weight	Last School	Notes
Malaki Branham	G	Fr.	6-4	175	St. Vincent - St. Mary HS (OH)	4-star recruit; 34th ranked player in the 2021 class. Scored 37 points in the Ohio Division II state championship game his senior year and was named Ohio's Mr. Basketball. A strong slasher and finisher, but is not really known for having a good 3P shot. He has a lot of competition for minutes, so becoming a better shooter will be something he needs to concentrate on.
Joey Brunk	C	RS Super Sr.	6-11	255	Indiana	Played for HC Chris Holtmann when he was at Butler. Played limited minutes his first two seasons. Jumped to 18.6 MPG his third year at Butler before transferring to Indiana for his senior season. Scored 7.6 and 6.8 PPG his junior and senior years. Sat out all of last year due to a back injury that required surgery. His main role will be rebounding and playing defense against Big Ten centers, something that 6-7 E.J. Liddell was forced to do last year.
Kalen Etzler	F	Fr.	6-8	195	Crestview HS (OH)	3-star recruit; 150th ranked player in the 2021 class. Not expect to play much this season due to the depth the Buckeyes already have.
Jamar Wheeler	G	Super Sr.	6-1	170	Penn State	Started every game for Penn State over the last two seasons. Was named to the Big Ten All-Defensive Team each of the last two seasons. Scored 3.0 PPG his first 3 seasons, then bumped that number to 6.8 his senior year. Shot 37% from 3 his last two seasons, but only 61% from the free throw line. Decent rebounder for a point guard. Will make most of his impact for the Buckeyes on the defensive end of the floor.

2021-22 Season Preview

- Rankings in “Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25”: #3 (Yahoo!), #5 (CBS), #4 (ESPN).
- G Duane Washington and F E.J. Liddell both declared for the NBA Draft, but still has the option to come back to school. Because of how deep this draft class is, they are both expected to return to Ohio State for one more season.
- The Buckeyes lost 3 players this offseason. G CJ Walker (NBA Draft), who battled a hand injury all season, ran the point guard position for Ohio State. He was 1st on the team in assist, 2nd in minutes played, and 4th in scoring. They also lost G Musa Jallow (transfer – Charlotte) and C Ibrhima Diallo (transfer), but neither played huge roles for them last season.
- The Buckeyes return 80% of their minutes played and 86% of points scored from last season.
- Ohio State currently has the 47th ranked recruiting class for 2021 made up of 4-star guard Malaki Branham and 3-star forward Kalen Etzler.
- The Buckeyes are also adding 2 transfers who will immediately make an impact: G Jamari Wheeler and C Joey Brunk.
- Ohio State had an excellent season last year overshadowed by a disappointing loss in the NCAA Tournament. They bring back all but one key contributor from last year’s team and add some talented pieces that will immediately make an impact. They also have 3 good sophomores who should play key roles for them off the bench. They are one of the favorites to not only win the Big Ten, but the National Championship as well.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Jamari Wheeler Super Senior	Duane Washington Jr. Senior	Justice Sueing RS - Senior	E.J. Liddell Junior	Joey Brunk RS – Super Senior
Meechie Johnson Jr. Sophomore	Malaki Branham Freshman	Eugene Brown III Sophomore	Kyle Young Super Senior	Zed Key Sophomore
Jimmy Sotos Super Senior		Justin Ahrens Senior	Seth Towns RS - Senior	

The Buckeyes currently sit at 14 scholarship players if Liddell and Washington return. Since Young and Sotos do not count towards the scholarship limit, they have 1 more scholarship for this season available.



Penn State Nittany Lions

Head Coach: Micah Shrewsberry
(1st Season)

Bryce Jordan Center
University Park, Pennsylvania



Key Returning Players

Seth Lundy	6'6"	F	10.1 PPG	23.8 MPG
John Harrar	6'9"	F	8.8 PPG	24.8 MPG
Myles Dread	6'4"	G	7.3 PPG	24.3 MPG

Key Players Lost

Myreon Jones	6'3"	G	20.1 PPG	35.1 MPG
Izaiah Brockington	7'0"	G	12.6 PPG	29.4 MPG
Jamari Wheeler	6'1"	G	6.8 PPG	31.2 MPG

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 11-14 (7-12 B1G) for a T-10th place finish in the B1G (finished 10th or worse 8 out of the last 10 seasons). No NCAAT appearance for the 9th consecutive season.
- Finished 44th in NET ranking, 40th in KenPom, and unranked in the final AP Poll or Coaches Poll.
- 3-11 Record in Quadrant I games.
- G Jamari Wheeler was named to the Big Ten All-Defensive Team for the second year in a row. He led the Big Ten in steals, but also helped his team offensively. He finished with a 2:1 AST/TO ratio and added 7 PPG.
- F John Harrar and G Myreon Jones were both selected as honorable mention All-Big Ten players. Jones finished 8th in the Big Ten in scoring (1st on the team), and 4th in 3PM/G. He also added 1.3 steals/game. Harrar averaged a double-double with points and rebounds over the months of January and February (13 games). He also ranks 11th nationally with 3.8 offensive rebounds per game.
- Scored 72.6 PPG, 131st most in the nation. Finished 34th in adj. offensive efficiency (7th B1G).
- Played man defense 94% of possessions. Gave up 73.0 PPG, 253rd fewest in the nation. Finished 52nd in adj. defensive efficiency (9th B1G).
- Pace of 69.1 rated 125th in the NCAA and 3rd in the Big Ten.
- Poor shooting team (47.9 eFG%; 268th) that allowed other teams to shoot well (53.0 opponent eFG%; 294th).
- Over 11% of their shot attempts were blocked (26th highest rate nationally), but they only blocked 6.9% of opponents' shots (265th).
- Played the hardest rated schedule in the nation.

Offseason Timeline

- March 11** – Lost to Wisconsin in the second round of the Big Ten Tournament to end their 2020-21 season.
- March 15** – Interim HC Jim Ferry is relieved of his duties, and Micah Shrewsberry is announced as the next Head Coach.
- March 16** – F Seth Lundy, F John Harrar, G Myreon Jones, G Jamari Wheeler, G Izaiah Brockington, and F Trent Buttrick enter the transfer portal. Jones eventually commits to Florida. Wheeler eventually commits to Ohio State. Buttrick eventually commits to UMass.
- March 18** – Adam Fisher (previously at Miami) is announced as an assistant coach.
- March 26** – G Izaiah Brockington withdraws from the transfer portal.
- April 7** – Aki Collins (previously at New Mexico) is announced as an assistant coach.
- April 10** – F Patrick Kelley transfers to Fordham.
- April 11** – Mike Farrelly (previously at Hofstra) is announced as an assistant coach.
- April 15** – F Seth Lundy withdraws from the transfer portal.
- April 20** – F John Harrar withdraws from the transfer portal.
- April 22** – G Izaiah Brockington re-enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Iowa State.
- April 23** – Former Gardner-Webb G Jaheam Cornwall commits to transfer to Penn State.
- April 25** – Former Siena G Jalen Pickett commits to transfer to Penn State.
- April 29** – G DJ Gordon enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Fordham. Former South Plains Junior College F Jevonnie Scott commits to transfer to Penn State.

Returning Players

Player Information				2020-21 Season Stats										Notes
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%			
#1 Seth Lundy	F	Jr.	6-6	219	15/25	23.8	10.1	4.2	0.8	38.5%	32.0%	81.3%	Started 15 games each of his first two seasons. Raised his 2P% by 6% but his 3P% fell by 7% from year 1 to year 2. While Lundy had 2 30 point games last year, he also had 7 games where he failed to record 5 points. His consistency must improve if hes going to take on a major role for this team.	
#2 Myles Dread	G	Sr.	6-4	220	8/23	24.3	7.3	2.0	1.1	35.9%	34.6%	75.0%	Has led the team in 3P shots made all 3 years of his career. Shoots 34% from 3P range for his career, and has shot 82% of his FGs from that distance in his 3 years. Has shown defensive versatility by being able to guard multiple positions.	
#3 Sam Sessoms	G	Sr.	6-0	187	0/24	20.7	8.2	2.0	2.3	40.8%	28.1%	71.4%	Was a standout at Binghamton for 2 years before transferring to Penn State. Averaged 18.6 PPG at Binghamton, but numbers went down his first year at PSU, especially from 3, where he only shot 28%. Has turned the ball over at a pretty high rate for his entire career.	
#4 Caleb Dorsey	F	So.	6-7	230	0/5	2.2	1.2	0.4	0.0	50.0%	50.0%	N/A	Former 3-star recruit. Only played 11 minutes this season. All 4 of his shot attempts were from 3P range. Will likley still need time to develop before making much of an impact on the court.	
#21 John Harrar	F	Super Sr.	6-9	240	25/25	24.8	8.8	8.8	1.3	54.9%	0.0%	68.9%	Played limited minutes his freshman season. His sophomore and junior years, he played 16.5 MPG. His scoring numbers were low but always very efficient. Last year, his efficiency numbers dropped, but he doubled his scoring and rebounding. Still the best FG% on the team, and 9th best offensive rebound rate in the nation. Limited offensively to scoring near the rim.	
#22 Dallion Johnson	G	So.	6-3	175	0/8	1.8	0.6	0.4	0.1	28.6%	16.7%	N/A	Former 3-star recruit. Only played 14 minutes his freshman year. 6 of his 7 shots came from 3P range. Will likley still need more time to develop before making much of an impact on the court.	
#30 Abdou Tsimbila	F	So.	6-8	235	0/16	4.6	1.1	1.6	0.1	42.1%	N/A	33.3%	Former 3-star recruit. Solid athlete with good length. Good timing on shot blocking. Struggled to keep from fouling this season. Picked up 21 fouls in just 73 minutes played. Still a work in progress, especially on offense. Very limited to finishing around the rim. Will make his impact on defense, but might not be this year.	
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)					94.7 (47%)	34.6 (48%)	5.5 (41%)	5.5 (41%)	17.8 (49%)					

New Players

		Position	Year	Height	Weight	Last School	Notes
Jaheam Cornwall		G	Super Sr.	6-0	175	Gardner-Webb	Was a role player his first two years at Gardner-Webb. Started all but one game his last two years while averaging 13.5 points. His best skill is his 3P shot, which he has hit at a 42% rate during his career. Had the 4th best assist rate in his conference last year. Struggled against the two power-5 teams he played last season (Pitt and FSU), scoring a combined 20 points on 5-22 shooting from the field.
Jalen Pickett		G	Sr.	6-4	202	Siena	Was listed as a top 25 overall transfer by ESPN. Michigan, Gonzaga, and Baylor were all involved in his recruitment. Won MAAC Player of the Year in 2020. Has averaged 15.0 PPG in his 3 seasons, with his lowest numbers coming last year (dealt with a hamstring injury through most of the year) when he averaged only 12.9. Averages over 6 APG during his career.
Jevonnie Scott		F	Jr.	6-7		South Plains Junior College	Was committed to Texas A&M but chnaged his mind and decided to join Coach Shrewsberry. Averaged 11.5 points and 5.6 rebounds per game last year. His freshman year, he averaged 8.1 points and 4.1 blocks per game. Brings energy and physicality. Runs the floor and finishes around the rim well.

2021-22 Season Preview

- Unranked in all current “Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25” by CBS, Yahoo!, and ESPN.
- After HC Micah Shrewsberry was hired, 8 players entered the transfer portal this offseason. 2 of them eventually returned to the Nittany Lions, but the team still lost 8 players overall from their roster last year. G Jamari Wheeler (transfer – Ohio State), G Myreon Jones (transfer – Florida), and G Izaiah Brockington (transfer – Iowa State) were among the most important guys lost and were the top 3 in minutes played for PSU last season.
- The Nittany Lions return 47% of their minutes played and 48% of points scored from last season.
- Penn State doesn’t have any 2021 recruits committed to the team at this time.
- The Nittany Lions are adding transfer guards: Jalen Pickett and Jaheam Cornwall. Pickett was the 21st ranked transfer of the offseason from ESPN, and he could end up being their best player this season.
- They are also adding a JUCO forward: Jevonnie Scott.
- Penn State only has 10 rostered players right now, and 4 of them (Johnson, Dorsey, Scott, and Tsimbila) haven’t shown that they will be ready to play consistent minutes at this level yet. While this roster still has moves to be made before opening night, I can’t see them adding enough talent to keep them out of the bottom of the Big Ten in Coach Shrewsberry’s first year.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Jalen Pickett Senior	Jaheam Cornwall Super Senior	Myles Dread Senior	Seth Lundy Junior	John Harrar Super Senior
	Sam Sessoms Senior	Dallion Johnson Sophomore	Jevonnie Scott Junior	Abdou Tsimbila Sophomore
			Caleb Dorsey Sophomore	

The Nittany Lions have 10 scholarship players on the roster, but Harrar doesn’t count towards the limit, so they still have room for 4 more players, and they will for sure be looking to add more players who can contribute.



Purdue Boilermakers

Head Coach: Matt Painter
(17th Season, 355-184)

Mackey Arena
West Lafayette, Indiana



Key Returning Players

Trevion Williams*	6'10"	F	15.5 PPG	21.5 MPG
Jaden Ivey	6'4"	G	10.2 PPG	33.7 MPG
Sasha Stefanovic	6'5"	G	9.3 PPG	29.4 MPG

Key Players Lost

Aaron Wheeler	6'9"	F	3.9 PPG	18.3 MPG
----------------------	------	---	---------	----------

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 18-10 (13-6 B1G) for a 4th place finish in the B1G (6th top-4 finish in the past 7 years). Sixth consecutive NCAAT appearance. Earned a 4 seed, lost to North Texas in the Round of 64.
- Finished 29th in NET ranking, 25th in KenPom, 20th in the final AP Poll, and unranked in the final Coaches Poll.
- 5-7 Record in Quadrant I games.
- Trevion Williams was named First Team All-Big Ten, AP Honorable mention All-American, and was named as a finalist for the Kareem Abdul-Jabbar Award. He was the only high major player to average 15+ points, 9+ rebounds, and 2+ assist per game. He ranked 2nd nationally in usage rate and 4th nationally in offensive rebound rate.
- Jaden Ivey had a great freshman year and was selected to the Big Ten's All-Freshman Team. Zach Edey, Brandon Newman, and Mason Gillis all made important contributions and showed impressive potential during their freshman seasons as well.
- Scored 71.0 PPG, 184th most in the nation. Finished 26th in adj. offensive efficiency (5th B1G).
- Played exclusively man defense. Gave up 66.7 PPG, 72nd fewest in the nation. Finished 34th in adj. defensive efficiency (3rd B1G).
- Pace of 76.1 rated 278th in the NCAA and 12th in the Big Ten.
- Allowed opponents to shoot 45.3% of their FGA from 3P range (23rd highest rate in the nation). Held opponents to 31.8% from 3 (74th best in the nation).
- 17th tallest team in the nation last year. 31st youngest team in the nation (in terms of years of experience).
- Were able to offensive rebound 32.8% of their own missed shots (36th) while only allowing opponents to offensive rebound 24.3% of their missed shots (39th)

Offseason Timeline

- March 19** – Lost to North Texas 78-69 in OT in the Round of 64.
- March 23** – F Aaron Wheeler enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to St. John's.
- March 30** – C Emmanuel Dowuona enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Tennessee State.
- April 6** – It is announced that Assistant Coach Steve Lutz will be leaving Purdue to become the Head Coach at Texas A&M – Corpus Christi.
- April 12** – Paul Lusk (previously at Creighton) is announced as an Assistant Coach. He replaces Micah Shrewsberry, who left the Boilermakers on March 15 to become the Head Coach at Penn State. Trevion Williams declares for the NBA Draft but will still remain eligible to possibly return to Purdue.
- April 21** – 2021 3-star forward Brian Waddell commits to Purdue.
- April 22** – Terry Johnson (previously at Ohio State) is announced as an Assistant Coach.

Returning Players

Player Information				2020-21 Season Stats									Notes
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%		
#0 Mason Gillis	F	RS So.	6-6	230	23/28	22.2	5.2	4.1	1.3	46.5%	35.2%	81.4%	Missed his whole senior season of high school due to a knee injury, then redshirted his first year at Purdue. Started the last 23 games of last season. Named Big Ten Freshman of the Week in December. Often made an impact that didn't always show up in the box score with his hustle and energy. Helped the Boilermakers close out games this season with his 81% FT shooting. Is a versatile complimentary player who will do a little bit of everything.
#2 Eric Hunter Jr.	G	Sr.	6-4	170	23/24	30.6	8.5	2.2	2.8	37.1%	27.2%	80.9%	Made huge improvements between his freshman and sophomore seasons, going from 2.2 to 10.6 PPG. Started 53 games combined his sophomore and junior seasons. Led the team in assist and MPG last season. Shot 36% from 3 his sophomore year, but dropped to 27% last year. Has shown he can be one of the best players for Purdue on both offense and defense, but needs to improve his game to game consistency going into his senior season.
#5 Brandon Newman	G	RS So.	6-5	195	23/28	23.6	8.0	3.5	1.3	39.8%	37.9%	93.8%	Former 3-star recruit; 126th ranked player in the 2019 class. Was named Big Ten Freshman of the Week in February. Scored 29 points in a win over Minnesota. Was known for his 3P shooting coming out of high school, but used his size and athleticism to prove he can score in other ways too. Led the team in FT% at 93.8%. Showed flashes of defensive capability, and was second on the team in steals.
#11 Isalah Thompson	G	Jr.	6-1	160	5/28	17.8	4.2	1.4	1.0	41.2%	39.7%	75.0%	Started the 5 games Newman missed for injury. Scored about 1 PPG less than his freshman year, but saw improvements in all of his efficiency numbers. Took 68% of his shots from 3, and made 40% of them. Had a less than 1 AST:TO ratio his freshman year, but made improvements and finished with a 2.1. Struggles on defense because of his size. Will make an impact this season by coming in and knocking down open shots when the defense is concentrating on other guys.
#15 Zach Edey	C	So.	7-4	285	2/28	14.7	8.7	4.4	0.4	59.7%	N/A	71.4%	Was named to the Big Ten All-Freshman Team and won Big Ten Freshman of the Week twice. Was one of 3 freshman to average 8+ points, 4+ rebounds, block 30+ shots, and shoot 57.5% from the field (the other two were Hunter Dickinson and Evan Mobely). Shot over 70% from the free throw line as a 7-4 center.
#23 Jaden Ivey	G	So.	6-4	200	12/23	24.2	11.1	3.3	1.9	39.9%	25.8%	72.6%	Former 4-star recruit; 89th ranked player in the 2020 class. Was named to the Big Ten All-Freshman Team and won Big Ten Freshman of the Week twice. Played his best basketball late in the season, averaging 18.2 PPG over the last 6 games, shooting 45/36/84 over that same stretch. Expected to be a major contributor on this team this season, and already projected to be a high pick in the 2022 NBA Draft.
#25 Ethan Morton	G	So.	6-6	215	0/23	8.7	0.6	0.8	0.9	25.0%	28.6%	N/A	Former 4-star recruit; 103rd ranked player in the 2020 class. Was diagnosed with mono before the start of last season and never really recovered. Was very limited in his playing time, but still has high potential as a player. Has excellent size for a point guard. Needs to improve on his scoring abilities, but has skills as a smart passer.
#50 Trevion Williams	F	Sr.	6-10	265	26/28	25.1	15.5	9.1	2.3	52.5%	0.0%	50.0%	One of the best players in the Big Ten. Entered his name into the NBA Draft, but is widely expected to return for his senior season. Achieved career highs in almost every statistical category last season. Great scorer 1v1 on the low block and has great passing abilities to hit the open man when the double team comes. Absolutely lethal on the offensive glass (104 offensive rebounds in 28 games!). Led them team in FTA, but only made 50% of them; really needs to improve there.
#55 Sasha Stefanovic	G	RS Sr.	6-5	200	21/25	29.4	9.3	2.6	2.6	41.6%	40.0%	84.2%	After averaging 2.2 PPG his freshman year, he has averaged 9.1 and 9.3 PPG the next two seasons. A career 39.4% 3P shooter who has improved his assist numbers every year (2.6 per game last year). 77% of his FGA have come from 3 throughout his career.
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)					183.5 (91%)	67.2 (95%)	33.2 (88%)	13.2 (95%)					

New Players

		Position	Year	Height	Weight	Last School	Notes
Caleb Furst	F	Fr.	6-10	230	Blackhawk Christian HS (IN)	4-star recruit; 61st ranked player in the 2021 class. Was named Mr. Basketball in Indiana in 2021. A very high floor power player who has a good scoring touch and a natural instinct for rebounding. Is an inside player who can't stretch a defense or guard on the perimeter yet. Is coming into a deep frontcourt at Purdue, but still talented enough to earn minutes his freshman season.	
Trey Kaufman-Renn	F	Fr.	6-9	220	Silver Creek HS (IN)	4-star recruit; 40th ranked player in the 2021 class. Good, but not explosive, athlete. Likes to play physically and will seek out contact. Can score from anywhere on the floor, including a very good 3P shot. Handles the ball and passes well for his position. Is able to guard inside and on the perimeter.	
Brian Waddell	F	Fr.	6-7	175	Carmel HS (IN)	3-star recruit. Good size, but will need to fill out his frame to consistently compete in the Big Ten. Great shooter. A likley reshirt candidate this season due to the depth ahead of him on this talented team.	

2021-22 Season Preview

- Rankings in “Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25”: #5 (Yahoo!), #11 (CBS), #5 (ESPN).
- F Trevion Williams declared for the NBA Draft, but is widely expected to just be testing the waters. If he surprises people and doesn’t return to school, the ceiling of this team will definitely fall.
- The Boilermakers lost 2 players this offseason. F Aaron Wheeler transferred to St. John’s, and F Emmanuel Dowuona transferred to Tennessee State. Neither of these departures really hurt Purdue because of their talent and depth in the frontcourt.
- The Boilermakers return 91% of their minutes played and 95% of points scored from last season.
- Purdue currently has the 37th ranked recruiting class for 2021 made up of 4-star forward Caleb Furst, 4-star forward Trey Kaufman-Renn, and 3-star forward Brian Waddell.
- Purdue has 1 more scholarship open but has not brought in anybody from the transfer portal yet.
- Purdue lost one contributor from last year’s team but brings in more talent than they lost with their freshman class. They are extremely deep in the frontcourt, and they have talent in the backcourt, but besides Ivey, the guard rotation is inconsistent. However, they will be competing for a chance at both a Big Ten Championship and a Final Four appearance.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Eric Hunter Jr. Senior	Jaden Ivey Sophomore	Sasha Stefanovic RS - Senior	Mason Gillis RS - Sophomore	Trevion Williams Senior
Ethan Morton Sophomore	Isaiah Thompson Junior	Brandon Newman RS – Sophomore	Trey Kaufman-Renn Freshman	Zach Edey Sophomore
				Caleb Furst Freshman

Purdue has 12 scholarship players right now, so they can add one more if they want to.



Rutgers Scarlet Knights

Head Coach: Steve Pikiell
(6th Season, 80-77)

Rutgers Athletic Center
Piscataway, New Jersey



Key Returning Players

Ron Harper Jr.*	6'6"	F	14.9 PPG	32.0 MPG
Geo Baker*	6'4"	G	10.4 PPG	31.2 MPG
Paul Mulcahy	6'6"	G	5.9 PPG	27.3 MPG

Key Players Lost

Jacob Young	6'2"	G	14.1 PPG	30.1 MPG
Myles Johnson	6'11"	C	8.0 PPG	24.7 MPG
Montez Mathis	6'4"	G	8.3 PPG	21.2 MPG

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 16-12 (10-10 B1G) for a T-6th place finish in the B1G (just the second time since 2001-02 to finish 6th or better). Started the season 7-1 including wins over Illinois and Purdue. First NCAAT appearance since 1990-91. Earned a 10 seed, lost to Houston in the Round of 32. First NCAAT game win since 1982-83.
- Finished 40th in NET ranking, 38th in KenPom, and unranked in the final AP Poll or Coaches Poll.
- 5-9 Record in Quadrant I games.
- F Ron Harper Jr. named as a top 20 player in the nation midseason by ESPN, was named on Wooden Award Late Season Watch List, and the Julius Erving Award Late Season List. He was recognized as Third Team All-Big Ten, and also earned a national player of the week award from ESPN in December. He led the team in minutes played, points scored, and 3P made, and was 2nd in rebounds.
- G Jacob Young was named honorable mention All-Big Ten and finished second in the Big Ten in steals while scoring in double digits in 24 of 28 games this season. He led the team in assist and finished 2nd in minutes played and points scored.
- Scored 69.3 PPG, 235th most in the nation. Finished 82nd in adj. offensive efficiency (9th B1G).
- Played man defense 96% of possessions. Gave up 67.6 PPG, 97th fewest in the nation. Finished 16th in adj. defensive efficiency (6th B1G).
- Pace of 67.4 rated 214th in the NCAA and 8th in the Big Ten.
- Poor free throw shooting team that didn't get to the line much (281st highest FT Rate, 331st rated FT%).
- Poor shooting 3P team that didn't attempt many from that range. (271st highest 3PA Rate, 287th highest 3P%).
- Scored 59% of their points from 2P shots (14th most nationally).

Offseason Timeline

- March 21** – Lost to Houston 63-60 in the Round of 32.
- March 25** – C Myles Johnson enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to UCLA.
- March 26** – G Jacob Young declares for the NBA Draft and enters the transfer portal to explore other college options.
- April 1** – F Mamadou Doucoure enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to La Salle.
- April 2** – F Ron Harper Jr. declares for the NBA Draft but will still remain eligible to possibly return to Rutgers.
- April 4** – G Montez Mathis enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to St. Johns.
- April 7** – G Geo Baker declares for the NBA Draft but will still remain eligible to possibly return to Rutgers.
- April 8** – Walk-on F Daniel Lobach enters the transfer portal.
- April 25** – Former LSU G Aundre Hyatt commits to transfer to Rutgers.

Returning Players

Player Information					2020-21 Season Stats									Notes
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%			
#0 Geo Baker	G	Super Sr.	6-4	195	22/25	31.2	10.4	3.1	3.2	40.9%	30.3%	75.0%	Started 100 games in his 4 years at Rutgers. Has been consistent in scoring through his career, averaging 11.1 PPG with a high of 12.2 his sophomore year. Struggled with his 3P shot the last two seasons, but sits at 32.5% for his career with about half of his attempts coming from that range. Currently 5th in assist in program history, has averaged 3.3/game over his career.	
#1 Oskar Palmquist	F	RS So.	6-8	220	0/12	5.0	0.8	0.7	0.4	16.7%	20.0%	50.0%	Former 3-star recruit. Redshirted his first year and played just 60 minutes in 12 games his second year. Shot 20% from 3 on the season with 10 of his 12 FGA this year coming from 3P range. Good athlete with experience competing on the national level for the Swedish national team.	
#3 Mawot Mag	F	So.	6-7	215	0/12	5.8	2.0	1.1	0.1	62.5%	33.3%	50.0%	Former 3-star recruit; 212th ranked player in the 2020 class. Played 70 minutes in 12 games his freshman season. Finished efficiently around the rim (69%). Good athlete who is known for playing hard on defense.	
#4 Paul Mulcahy	G	Jr.	6-6	210	21/28	27.3	5.9	3.3	2.9	47.9%	39.3%	67.5%	Pass-first point guard with good size for his position. High basketball IQ. Played in all 59 games possible in his two seasons. Started 21 games his sophomore year. Has a 2:1 AST/TO ratio through his two seasons. Improved his 3P shooting from 33 to 39% from freshman to sophomore year. Expected to play a lot for the Knights this season after losing Jacob Young.	
#5 Clifford Omoruyi	C	So.	6-11	240	6/23	14.9	3.8	4.0	0.2	63.2%	50.0%	42.4%	Former 4-star recruit; 51st ranked player in the 2020 class. Missed nearly a month of his freshman season due to a knee injury. Great athlete with impressive strength. Relies on power rather than mobility or quickness. Limited offensively to an at the rim finisher. Needs to improve his FT shooting (42% last year). Doesn't have much of an offensive skill set yet. Also a great rebounder and rim protector. Will be asked to play an increased role after the transfer of Myles Johnson.	
#21 Dean Reiber	F	So.	6-10	225	0/13	5.8	0.8	0.8	0.1	30.0%	0.0%	83.3%	Former 3-star recruit. Played 76 minutes in 13 games his freshman year. His best game came vs Iowa where he provided 2 blocks, 2 rebounds, 1 steal, and 1 assist in 10 minutes. Good passing and ball handling for his size. Has shown the ability to hit 3P shots, but went 0/3 his first season. Strong frame and shows some explosiveness when jumping.	
#22 Caleb McConnell	G	Sr.	6-7	195	8/20	22.9	5.7	4.3	1.6	31.7%	20.4%	80.0%	Started 21 games his sophomore season. Missed the beginning of this year due to a back injury. Long, athletic guard who rebounds the ball well. Shot 56% from 3 his freshman year but has struggled since, only hitting 20% last year. 80% career FT shooter. Needs to improve his 3P shot for next season, but will make an impact on the team as a defender regardless.	
#24 Ron Harper Jr.	F	Sr.	6-6	245	27/27	32.0	14.9	5.9	1.6	44.1%	31.0%	73.6%	77 starts in 3 seasons for the Knights. Best player for Rutgers last season. Has increased his scoring all 3 years of his career. Only a career 31% 3P shooter, but scores efficiently in the paint. Good rebounder as well. Played power forward often last year and was able to exploit his matchups with his quickness. Versatile defender due to his strength and quickness.	
#45 Jaden Jones	G/F	So.	6-8	195	0/4	2.8	0.8	0.3	0.8	16.7%	50.0%	N/A	Former 3-star recruit; 154th ranked player in the 2020 class. Reclassified from the 2021 class to join the team in January and saw minutes in 4 games last year. He's a score first wing with good size and long arms. Needs to gain strength. Prefers to score with his jumpshot, but is capable of scoring on all 3 levels in a variety of ways. His size and length gives him good potential as a defender.	
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)					122.5 (61%)	38.3 (55%)	19.2 (54%)	8.8 (64%)						

New Players

		Position	Year	Height	Weight	Last School	Notes
Aundre Hyatt	G	Jr.	6-6	225	LSU	Started 15 games for LSU last season. Didn't fit into LSU's iso style offense. His best strength is his offensive rebounding. Was a good 3P shooter in HS and AAU circuits, but struggled in his time at LSU (26%). Uses his length (7-4 wingspan) to be a relentless defender on the perimeter.	
Jalen Miller	G	Fr.	6-3	190	Bishop Walsh HS (DC)	3-star recruit; 189th ranked player in the 2021 class. Combo guard who prefers to play the point. Best when he is attacking the defense off the dribble. Makes good decisions. Gives a lot of effort on the defensive end of the floor.	

2021-22 Season Preview

- Unranked in all current "Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25" by CBS, Yahoo!, and ESPN.
- G Geo Baker and F Ron Harper Jr. are both testing waters for the NBA Draft. Baker is almost certain to not get drafted but could explore other pro-opportunities. Harper could raise his draft stock high enough to see draft interest with a good combine performance. However, both are more likely than not to return to Rutgers next season.
- The Scarlet Knights lost 5 players this offseason, including 3 of their 5 leading scorers. G Montez Mathis (St. John's) and C Myles Johnson (UCLA) transferred out of the program, while G Jacob Young is exploring professional opportunities.
- The Scarlet Knights return 61% of their minutes played and 55% of points scored from last season.
- Rutgers currently has the 96th ranked recruiting class for 2021. G Jalen Miller is the only recruit coming into the program this season as of now. G Jaden Jones was supposed to be a part of this class before he reclassified and joined the team early.
- The Scarlett Knights are also adding transfer G Aundre Hyatt. He left LSU after not fitting in with their iso system on offense. At bare minimum, he will bring provide a good defensive presence to the team.
- This Rutgers program is still looking to add pieces to the roster, so their outlook can change a lot by the time the season rolls around. If Baker and Harper both return, and they can add one or two more contributors (specifically a big and maybe another PG), they will likely finish around the lower middle of the Big Ten standings and have a shot at making consecutive NCAAT appearances.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Paul Mulcahy Junior	Geo Baker Super Senior	Caleb McConnell Senior	Ron Harper Jr. Senior	Clifford Omoruyi Sophomore
Jalen Miller Freshman	Aundre Hyatt Junior	Jaden Jones Sophomore	Mawot Mag Sophomore	Dean Reiber Sophomore
			Oskar Palmquist RS - Sophomore	

The Scarlet Knights only have 11 scholarship players right now, and Baker does not count towards the limit. They have 3 scholarships open and are looking to add more guys for the upcoming year.



Wisconsin Badgers

Head Coach: Greg Gard
(6th Season, 119-70)

Kohl Center
Madison, Wisconsin



Key Returning Players

Brad Davison	6'4"	G	10.0 PPG	31.0 MPG
Jonathan Davis	6'5"	G	7.0 PPG	24.3 MPG
Tyler Wahl	6'9"	F	5.2 PPG	24.7 MPG

Key Players Lost

D'Mitrik Trice	6'0"	G	13.9 PPG	33.3 MPG
Micah Potter	6'10"	F	12.5 PPG	22.2 MPG
Aleem Ford	6'8"	F	8.7 PPG	26.4 MPG

2020-21 Season Notes

- Went 18-13 (10-10 B1G) for a T-6th place finish in the B1G (only the second time since 2000-01 to not finish in the top 5). 21st NCAAT appearance in the past 22 seasons. Earned a 9 seed, lost to Baylor in the Round of 32. Lost 7 of their last 10 games of the season.
- Finished 23rd in NET ranking, 14th in KenPom, unranked in the final AP Poll or Coaches Poll.
- 5-11 Record in Quadrant I games.
- D'Mitrik Trice earned Third Team All-Big Ten after leading the team in minutes played, points, and assist.
- Scored 69.9 PPG, 208th most in the nation. Finished 29th in adj. offensive efficiency (6th B1G).
- Played exclusively man defense. Gave up 64.6 PPG, 43rd fewest in the nation. Finished 15th in adj. defensive efficiency (4th B1G).
- Pace of 64.6 rated 328th in the NCAA and 14th in the Big Ten.
- Average offensive possession lasted 19.0 seconds, 38th longest in the nation.
- Scored 37.2% of their points on 3P shots, 39th highest rate in the nation.
- Only turned the ball over on 13.6% of possessions, 3rd fewest in the nation.
- 22nd most experienced team in the nation. 39th tallest team in the nation.

Offseason Timeline

- **March 21** – Lost to Baylor 76-63 in the Round of 32.
- **March 21** – G D'Mitrik Trice announces that he will not return for his extra year of eligibility.
- **March 22** – F Aleem Ford announces that he will not return for his extra year of eligibility. G Walt McGoroy enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to South Dakota.
- **March 24** – F Micah Potter announces that he will not return for his extra year of eligibility.
- **March 25** – G Trevor Anderson enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Valparaiso.
- **March 26** – F Nate Reuvers enters the transfer portal. He eventually decides to turn pro and hire an agent.
- **March 30** – C Joe Hedstrom enters the transfer portal and eventually commits to Valparaiso.
- **April 8** – Former walk-on F Carter Gilmore is put on scholarship.
- **April 14** – G Brad Davison announces that he will return to Wisconsin to use his extra year of eligibility.
- **April 16** – Former Wake Forest G Jahcobi Neath commits to transfer to Wisconsin.
- **April 27** – Reported that Interim Assistant Coach Alando Tucker would not be returning to the team next season. He has been in this role for two seasons while Assistant Coach Howard Moore has been on medical leave.
- **May 8** – Former Cincinnati C Chris Vogt commits to transfer to Wisconsin.

Returning Players

Player Information						2020-21 Season Stats								Notes
Position	Year	Height	Weight	GS/GP	MIN/G	PTS/G	REB/G	AST/G	FG%	3P%	FT%			
#1 Jonathan Davis	G	So.	6-5	196	0/31	24.3	7.0	4.1	1.1	44.1%	38.9%	72.7%	Former 3-star recruit; 164th ranked player in the 2020 class. Played the most minutes out of all bench players on the team. Played in all 31 games while no other freshman played in more than 13. Scored in double digits nine times last year. Led the team in steals. Athletic and lengthy guard. Can create his own shots and plays with a slasher's mentality. Will be one of the most experienced players on the Badgers this season.	
#5 Tyler Wahl	F	Jr.	6-9	220	18/31	24.7	5.2	4.3	1.4	43.6%	27.8%	56.7%	Played 15 MPG in 31 games his freshman season. Played in all 31 games last season and started the last 18 of the year. Had hot streaks from the 3p line showing potential, but finished 27.8% from that range overall. Athletic enough to get to the rim against most defenders, but needs to work on his finishing for when he gets there. Team's most versatile defender and a true asset on that side of the floor. Quick enough to stay with guards and long enough to guard bigs in the post.	
#10 Lorne Bowman II	G	So.	6-2	180									Former 3-star recruit; 194th ranked player in the 2020 class. He left campus before the season started to return home and tend to a personal family matter. In March it was announced that he would be headed back to Madison and was ready to rejoin the team. Crafty point guard who relies on excellent footwork rather than exceptional speed or athleticism.	
#14 Carter Gilmore	F	So.	6-7	215	0/9	1.9	0.2	0.3	0.0	20.0%	0.0%	N/A	Played 17 minutes as a freshman. 4 of his 5 shots on the season came from behind the 3P line. Was put on scholarship this offseason.	
#20 Ben Carlson	F	So.	6-9	218	0/7	9.1	2.9	0.9	0.6	54.5%	33.3%	87.5%	Former 4-star recruit; 107th ranked player in the 2020 class. Played in 7 games (64 minutes) this season as a freshman. Highly skilled combo forward with great mobility and body control. Good athlete but not explosive or quick. Has shown promise as a 3p shooter. Fits most naturally into a stretch 4 role. Makes plays in transition as a ball handler. Good rim protector on the defensive end.	
#22 Steven Crowl	F	So.	7-0	217	0/12	3.3	0.7	0.8	0.2	50.0%	0.0%	N/A	Former 3-star recruit. Played 39 minutes in 12 games his freshman year. Modern center who is a great passer for his size and can step out and hit set jump shots.	
#24 Jordan Davis	G	So.	6-4	202	0/13	1.5	0.6	0.1	0.0	50.0%	40.0%	N/A	Former 3-star recruit. Played 19 minutes in 13 games his freshman season. A wing slasher who needs to improve his offensive shooting. Solid defender and rebounder for his position.	
#34 Brad Davison	G	Super Sr.	6-4	202	31/31	31.0	10.0	3.5	2.4	34.5%	38.9%	86.8%	Has been a starter in 124 of 128 of his games as a Badger. Almost all of his year to year stats are eerily similar as you go from his freshman to senior seasons one by one. By this point you know what you are getting from him night in and night out, which will be a good thing to have this season with a roster full of mostly inexperienced guys.	
Returning Totals (% of Production Returning From Last Season)					85.0 (42%)	23.5 (34%)	12.5 (37%)	5.1 (38%)						

New Players

		Position	Year	Height	Weight	Last School	Notes
Chucky Hephburn	G	Fr.	6-1	185		Bellevue West HS (NE)	3-star recruit; 119th ranked player in the 2021 class. Crafty and athletic point guard. Has an unorthodox release on his jumpshot that may not translate well to the college game. Has shown the ability to hit set shots or shots off the dribble in high school. Good at finishing through contact at the rim. Already has the physicality to play at the college level. Good off ball offensive player. Plays just as hard on defense as on offense.
Chris Hodges	F	Fr.	6-8	235		Schaumburg HS (IL)	3-star recruit; 157th ranked player in the 2021 class. Opted out of his senior season of high school competition. Runs the floor well and finishes through contact. Lives in the paint offensively.
Markus Ilver	F	Fr.	6-8	195		Western Reserve Academy (OH)	3-star recruit; 131st ranked player in the 2021 class. Known for his ability to stretch the floor with his 3P shot. Has a very quick release on his jump shot. Very good athlete who can be versatile on the defensive end.
Matthew Mors	F	Fr.	6-7	220		Yankton HS (SD)	3-star recruit; 149th ranked player in the 2021 class. Is a polished post player who can shoot from mid-range as well.
Jahcobi Neath	G	Jr.	6-3	200		Wake Forest	Started 9 out of 50 games in his two seasons at Wake Forest. Shot 48% from 3 as a freshman but only 22% as a sophomore. He did shoot 91% from the free throw line last year. Explosive leaper who can finish with authority. Has playmaking skills, but is inconsistent and struggles with turnovers.
Chris Vogt	C	Super Sr.	7-1	260		Cincinnati	Played limited roles for two seasons at Northern Kentucky. Transferred to Cincy, where he played a major role on their team his junior year. He averaged over 28 MPG and 11 PPG. His numbers dropped his senior year though, and he didn't have the volume, or efficiency that he did the year prior. Limited to inside scoring, and very poor FT shooter (46% on his career). Will play his biggest role defensively.

2021-22 Season Preview

- Unranked in all current “Way-Too-Early 2021-22 Top 25” by CBS, Yahoo!, and ESPN.
- The Badgers lost 7 players this offseason, including 5 of the 8 players from last season’s main rotation. Trice, Ford, Potters, and Reuvers all decided not to use their extra years of eligibility to return, while Hedstrom (Valparaiso), Anderson (Valparaiso), and McGrory (South Dakota) all decided to transfer.
- The Badgers return 42% of their minutes played but only 34% of points scored from last season.
- Wisconsin currently has the 31st ranked recruiting class for 2021 made up of four 3-star players. The highest ranked out of the group is 118th overall Chucky Hepburn.
- The Badgers are also adding 2 transfers. Former Wake Forest PG Jahcobi Neath lost minutes his sophomore season after a coaching change and his on-court performance declined and is looking to have a bounce back season in Madison. C Chris Vogt joins the team after having a down year for Cincinnati last year. He brings much needed depth and experience to the center rotation.
- After having one of the most experienced lineups in the country last season, these Badgers look to be the exact opposite. Outside of Davison, Jonathan Davis, and Wahl, it’s hard to project who will play, how many minutes, and at what position because of how little we have seen from most of these guys. Davison coming back will provide a much-needed veteran presence for the young guys to learn from, but I don’t think he keeps this team out of the bottom third of the Big Ten this year.

Projected Depth Chart

PG	SG	SF	PF	C
Jahcobi Neath Junior	Brad Davison Super Senior	Jonathan Davis Sophomore	Tyler Wahl Junior	Steven Crowl Sophomore
Lorne Bowman II Sophomore	Jordan Davis Sophomore	Markus Ilver Freshman	Ben Carlson Sophomore	Chris Vogt Super Senior
Chucky Hepburn Freshman		Carter Gilmore Sophomore	Matthew Mors Freshman	
			Chris Hodges Freshman	

The Badgers have 14 players on scholarship right now. Davison doesn’t count towards the limit, so the Badgers roster is at “13” and full for the upcoming season.